LICENSED BUILDING PRACTITIONER · NEW ZEALAND

LBP CARPENTRY PRACTICE ASSESSMENT

237 multiple-choice questions in 8 study areas, written the way an assessor asks them. The answer key with explanations is at the back.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOKLET

1. Pick a study area and answer every question in it. Tick a box: A, B, C or D.
2. Mark your answers with the quick answer grid at the start of the answer key.
3. Read the explanation for every question you missed or guessed. The reference tells you where to look it up.
4. Mark the questions you want to go over and bring them to a study session or to Claude.

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SOURCES

The LBP Handbook (MBIE), Carpentry licence class competencies (LBP Rules Schedule 1), Building Act 2004, NZS 3604:2011 as cited by B1/AS1 2nd edition, E2/AS1 4th edition, B2/AS1 3rd edition, H1/AS1 6th edition, the Building Product Specifications, GIB EzyBrace guidance, the Construction Contracts Act 2002 and WorkSafe guidance. Checked October 2026. Where the LBP Handbook is out of date (for example, the Board's maximum fine is $10,000 under s318, not $50,000), the questions follow the Act. Rules change, so check the current documents on building.govt.nz and lbp.govt.nz before your assessment.

RBW

RESTRICTED BUILDING WORK & RECORDS OF WORK

What is and isn't RBW, owner-builders, supervision, and records of work. Questions 1–37.

1 SITE SCENARIO

You've framed and closed in a new house when the owner ends your contract, before the cladding goes on. The owner says you don't need to do a record of work because the house isn't finished. What do you do?

- A Give a record of work for the RBW you carried out or supervised up to the day you left, to the owner and the council.
- B Nothing yet. A record of work is only due once the whole house is complete.
- C Pass your notes to the next builder so your work goes on their record of work.
- D Provide the record of work once the owner has paid your final invoice.

---

2 SITE SCENARIO

You're asked to frame a new three-storey building with a café on the ground floor and two apartments above. It needs a building consent. Is the structural framing restricted building work?

- A Yes. Any building with apartments in it counts as residential.
- B Only the framing for the two apartment floors.
- C Only if the building is more than 10 m high.
- D No. RBW covers houses and purely residential small-to-medium apartment buildings, and this building is mixed-use.

---

3 SITE SCENARIO

You're the LBP carpenter running a job. Another LBP carpenter on your crew fixes all the wall cladding. Who provides the record of work for the cladding?

- A The building company provides one record of work covering the whole crew.
- B You do, because you're supervising the whole job.
- C Nobody. Wall cladding isn't restricted building work.
- D The other LBP. An LBP can't supervise another LBP in the same licence class, so each LBP who does RBW provides their own record of work.

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4 RULE CHECK

Which of these jobs on a house is NOT restricted building work?

- A Demolishing an old house to clear the site
- B Installing the windows in a new extension
- C Framing the roof of a new house
- D Replacing a load-bearing wall with a beam

---

5 SITE SCENARIO

A homeowner wants you to replace rotten wall framing and weatherboards caused by a long-term leak, using the same materials. They say it's just maintenance, so no consent is needed. What's the correct position?

- A They're right. Like-for-like repairs are always exempt.
- B It isn't exempt. Repairing work that failed its durability requirements (like a leak) or substantially replacing structural framing needs a building consent, so it's RBW.
- C Only the weatherboards need a consent.
- D It's exempt as long as you use treated timber this time.

---

6 SITE SCENARIO

You're building a deck that is exempt from building consent under Schedule 1 (no one could fall more than 1.5 m). Is the deck framing restricted building work?

- A Yes. Any structural framing is RBW.
- B No. Work that doesn't need a building consent isn't RBW (consent-exempt granny flats aside), though it must still meet the Building Code.
- C Yes, because it's attached to a house.
- D Only if an LBP builds it.

---

7 SITE SCENARIO

An owner-builder is building their own home. They want to pay their unlicensed nephew to fix the wall cladding. Is that allowed?

- A Yes. The owner-builder exemption covers anyone the owner hires.
- B Yes, as long as the nephew is a qualified builder.
- C No. The exemption only covers RBW the owner does personally or with unpaid friends and family. Paid workers doing RBW must be LBPs or supervised by one.
- D Yes, if the owner signs off the work.

---

8 RULE CHECK

Which of these is NOT a condition of the owner-builder exemption?

- A The owner lives in, or intends to live in, the home (including as a holiday home)
- B The owner hasn't used the exemption for a different home in the previous 3 years
- C The owner provides a statutory declaration to the BCA
- D The owner holds a building trade qualification

---

9 RULE CHECK

Can the owner-builder exemption be used to build a consent-exempt granny flat (small stand-alone dwelling) under Schedule 1A?

- A No. The owner-builder exemption isn't available for Schedule 1A granny flats.
- B Yes, if the owner will live in it.
- C Only if the flat is under 30 m^2.
- D Yes, the same as any other home.

---

10 RULE CHECK

Who must receive your record of work?

- A The main contractor only
- B The owner and the territorial authority (the council)
- C The BCA inspector at the final inspection
- D The LBP Registrar

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11 RULE CHECK

When is your record of work due?

- A When the code compliance certificate is issued
- B Within 12 months of starting the job
- C On completion of the RBW you carried out or supervised, even if the rest of the job is still going
- D Only when the owner asks for it

---

12 SITE SCENARIO

The client still hasn't paid your final invoice. Can you hold back your record of work until they pay?

- A Yes. It's your leverage for payment.
- B Yes, if your contract says so.
- C Only if the amount owing is over $5,000.
- D No. A record of work can't be withheld over payment or any other dispute. Recover the money through your contract or the Construction Contracts Act.

---

13 SITE SCENARIO

You're a subcontracted LBP. The main contractor says to hand your record of work to them and they'll pass it on. Is that enough?

- A No. You're responsible for making sure your record of work reaches the owner and the council.
- B Yes, if they sign a receipt.
- C Only if the main contractor is also an LBP.
- D Yes. The main contractor is responsible for it after that.

---

14 RULE CHECK

What does a record of work do?

- A Records which restricted building work you carried out or supervised. It doesn't, of itself, create any liability.
- B Gives the owner a 10-year guarantee
- C Replaces the code compliance certificate
- D Certifies that the work complies with the Building Code

---

15 SITE SCENARIO

You supervised an unlicensed second-year apprentice who installed all the windows on a new house. Who provides the record of work for the windows?

- A The apprentice, because they did the work
- B You do, as the LBP who supervised the RBW
- C The window supplier
- D Nobody. Apprentices don't need records of work.

---

16 RULE CHECK

What can happen if you fail to provide a record of work without good reason?

- A Nothing. It's only a guideline.
- B The council refuses to issue your next consent.
- C It's a ground for discipline by the Building Practitioners Board, and recent penalties include fines of $1,000 to $1,500 plus costs.
- D You lose your licence automatically.

---

17 RULE CHECK

What's the difference between a certificate of work and a record of work?

- A They're the same document with different names.
- B A certificate of work comes from the builder at the end of the job.
- C A record of work is only for design.
- D A certificate of work comes from the design LBP with the consent application; a record of work comes from each LBP who carries out or supervises RBW.

---

18 RULE CHECK

How does the Building Act define supervise?

- A Being on site for at least half of the working day
- B Providing control or direction and oversight of the work, enough to ensure it's done competently and complies with the building consent (if any)
- C Holding a higher licence class than the worker
- D Signing off the work once it's finished

---

19 SITE SCENARIO

A first-year apprentice is installing windows into a cavity system on a complex architectural house. What level of supervision fits?

- A Direct: be there, guiding and checking the work as it's done
- B General: drop in once a week
- C None, if the window supplier's instructions are on site
- D Remote: check the photos at the end of the day

---

20 RULE CHECK

Which statement about supervising RBW is true?

- A You must be on site the whole time.
- B Once you've told the worker what to do, you're no longer responsible.
- C Any experienced builder can supervise RBW.
- D You don't have to be on site all the time, but you're responsible for the quality and compliance of the work you supervise.

---

21 RULE CHECK

Who can supervise building work that is NOT restricted building work?

- A Only an LBP
- B Only a Site LBP
- C Anyone, although an LBP who does or supervises it is still accountable for it
- D Only the BCA

---

22 RULE CHECK

Which RBW can a Carpentry LBP NOT carry out or supervise?

- A Framing the walls and roof of a house
- B Fixing weatherboards and installing windows
- C Laying lightweight corrugated steel roofing
- D Laying a clay brick veneer

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23 RULE CHECK

Can a Site LBP carry out or supervise restricted building work?

- A No. The Site licence covers coordinating and overseeing building work, not carrying out or supervising RBW, so Site LBPs don't issue records of work.
- B Yes, but only on Category 1 buildings.
- C Only if they also hold a design licence.
- D Yes, on any category of building.

---

24 RULE CHECK

What's the maximum fine for a person who carries out RBW without being licensed or supervised by an appropriately licensed LBP?

- A $5,000
- B $20,000
- C $50,000
- D $200,000

---

25 RULE CHECK

An owner knowingly engages an unlicensed person to do RBW on their house. What's the maximum fine for an individual owner?

- A $1,000
- B $10,000
- C $50,000
- D $500,000

---

26 SITE SCENARIO

A block of three attached townhouses is purely residential and 9 m high. You're framing it under a building consent. Is the framing RBW?

- A No. RBW only covers stand-alone houses.
- B Yes. It's a small-to-medium apartment building: two or more residential units, no commercial units, under 10 m high.
- C Only the framing for the end units.
- D Only if the owner lives in one of them.

---

27 RULE CHECK

You're building a detached garage on a residential section under a building consent. Is the garage framing RBW?

- A Yes. Everything on a residential section is RBW.
- B Yes, because it needs a consent.
- C No. RBW covers houses and small-to-medium apartment buildings, not detached garages, sheds and other outbuildings.
- D Only if it's bigger than 40 m^2.

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28 SITE SCENARIO

In a consented kitchen renovation, you re-line a wall that the plans show as a plasterboard bracing element. Is that RBW?

- A No. Linings are never RBW.
- B No. Kitchens are internal work.
- C Only if the wall is external.
- D Yes. Bracing is part of the primary structure, so the bracing element is RBW and needs an LBP to carry it out or supervise it.

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29 SITE SCENARIO

In the same consented renovation, you move a non-load-bearing, non-bracing internal partition. Is that RBW?

- A Yes. All work under a consent is RBW.
- B No. It isn't primary structure or the external moisture-management system.
- C Only if you're the LBP for the job.
- D Yes, if it has a door in it.

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30 SITE SCENARIO

The owner of a single-storey house wants you to replace an old aluminium window with a new one of the same size, in the same position. There's no history of leaks. What's the likely position?

- A It needs a consent and is RBW.
- B It needs a consent but isn't RBW.
- C It can be exempt under Schedule 1 (window and door replacement in an existing dwelling of two storeys or less), so it isn't RBW. It must still meet the Building Code.
- D It's only exempt if the owner does it themselves.

---

31 SITE SCENARIO

Halfway through a consented build, the LBP carpenter running the job leaves and another LBP takes over. What has to happen?

- A The first LBP gives a record of work for their RBW so far, and the owner tells the BCA about the new LBP who will carry out or supervise the RBW.
- B The new LBP signs a record of work for the whole house.
- C The BCA cancels the consent.
- D Nothing. The new LBP's record of work will cover everything.

---

32 SITE SCENARIO

As an LBP, you do a commercial shop fit-out (not RBW) and the work is negligent. Can the Building Practitioners Board discipline you?

- A Yes. LBPs are accountable to the Board for all building work they carry out or supervise, including work that isn't RBW.
- B No. Commercial work is covered by the Fair Trading Act.
- C Only if the client is a homeowner.
- D No. The Board only deals with RBW.

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33 RULE CHECK

Is the structural work on a consent-exempt granny flat built under Schedule 1A restricted building work?

- A No. Work without a consent is never RBW.
- B Only the foundations.
- C Only if the owner asks for a record of work.
- D Yes. Since 15 January 2026, RBW includes consent-exempt granny flats, so LBPs must carry out or supervise it and provide records of work.

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34 RULE CHECK

Since what date has restricted building work had to be carried out or supervised by an LBP?

- A 1 November 2007
- B 1 March 2012
- C 1 January 2015
- D 25 October 2022

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35 RULE CHECK

Which of these is part of a house's primary structure for RBW purposes?

- A Kitchen cabinets
- B Internal doors
- C Subfloor framing and bracing
- D Skirting boards

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36 RULE CHECK

Which of these is part of a house's external moisture-management system?

- A The bathroom wall tiles
- B The wall cladding, flashings, wall underlay and window installation
- C The internal wall linings
- D The ceiling insulation

---

37 SITE SCENARIO

A client offers you a job framing a two-storey house on a site with complex ground conditions and engineer-designed foundations, which you haven't done before. What should you do?

- A Take it. Your Carpentry licence covers all foundations work.
- B Take it and learn as you go.
- C Only take it on if you can do it competently, for example with the engineer's input and experienced support, and be upfront about your experience.
- D Turn down all work you haven't done before.

WEATHERTIGHTNESS & CLEARANCES

Ground and roof clearances, the risk matrix, cavities, windows, flashings and decks (4th edition). Questions 38–85.

38 SITE SCENARIO

On a slab-on-ground house, the landscaper has poured a concrete path hard up against the wall. The bottom of the weatherboards is now 60 mm above the path. What's the minimum clearance from a paved surface to the bottom of the cladding?

- A 35 mm
- B 50 mm
- C 100 mm
- D 175 mm

39 RULE CHECK

What's the minimum height of a concrete slab floor above finished unpaved ground (for claddings other than masonry veneer)?

- A 100 mm
- B 150 mm
- C 175 mm
- D 225 mm

40 RULE CHECK

A single house has one elevation with an E2/AS1 risk matrix score of 13. Every other elevation scores under 12. What building category is it for LBP purposes?

- A Category 2
- B Category 1
- C Category 3
- D It can't be classed until the cladding is chosen

41 RULE CHECK

Which of these is NOT one of the six risk factors in the E2/AS1 building envelope risk matrix?

- A Distance from the coast
- B Number of storeys
- C Deck design
- D Envelope complexity

42 CALCULATION

Work out the risk score for this elevation: Very High wind zone, two storeys, gable roof with eaves (roof/wall intersection fully protected), 450 mm eaves, simple rectangular shape with one cladding, and a timber slat deck attached at first-floor level.

- A 7
- B 9
- C 11
- D 13

43 SITE SCENARIO

An elevation scores 9 on the risk matrix. The plans show fibre cement weatherboards. What does E2/AS1 require?

- A Direct fixing is fine, because weatherboards can be direct fixed up to a score of 12.
- B A rigid underlay instead of a cavity.
- C Specific design, because the score is over 6.
- D Fix them over a nominal 20 mm drained cavity.

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44 RULE CHECK

Up to what risk score can bevel-back timber weatherboards be direct fixed to the framing under E2/AS1?

- A 6
- B 12
- C 20
- D Any score, because timber weatherboards never need a cavity

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45 SITE SCENARIO

The risk matrix for one face of a proposed house comes out at 22. What are the options under E2/AS1?

- A Use any cladding over a drained cavity.
- B Use a rigid underlay with a drained cavity.
- C Use masonry veneer, which suits any risk score.
- D Redesign to bring the score down, or treat that face as specific design outside E2/AS1.

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46 RULE CHECK

How is eaves width measured for the E2/AS1 risk matrix?

- A Horizontally from the outside face of the wall cladding to the outer edge of the overhang, including fascia and gutter.
- B Along the slope of the soffit lining.
- C From the top plate to the fascia.
- D From the wall framing to the end of the rafter.

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47 RULE CHECK

One face of a house has a parapet instead of eaves. What eaves width do you use for that face in the risk matrix?

- A The width of the capping
- B The parapet height
- C 100 mm
- D 0 mm

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48 RULE CHECK

An enclosed deck is cantilevered out at first-floor level. What does it score for deck design in the risk matrix?

- A 0 (low)
- B 2 (medium)
- C 4 (high)
- D 6 (very high)

---

49 RULE CHECK

What size cavity battens does E2/AS1 call for behind a cladding on a drained cavity?

- A 10–15 mm thick, any width
- B Nominal 20 mm (18–25 mm thick) and at least 45 mm wide
- C At least 30 mm thick and 70 mm wide
- D Any size, as long as they're fixed with the cladding fixings

---

50 RULE CHECK

Behind fibre cement weatherboards on a drained cavity, how should the cavity be finished at the top and bottom?

- A Drained and open to the outside at the bottom (with vermin-proofing), but not vented at the top.
- B Sealed at the bottom and vented at the top.
- C Vented at the top and bottom so air can flow straight through.
- D Sealed at both ends to stop wind-driven rain getting in.

---

51 RULE CHECK

What size openings must the vermin-proofing (cavity closer) at the base of a drained cavity have?

- A 1–2 mm holes
- B 6–10 mm slots
- C 3–5 mm holes or slots, giving at least 1000 mm² of opening per metre of wall
- D 12 mm gaps every 600 mm

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52 RULE CHECK

Above a window head flashing on a cavity wall, how far must the cladding extend past the vermin-proofing to form a drip edge?

- A 5 mm
- B 10 mm
- C 15 mm
- D 25 mm

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53 SITE SCENARIO

Your apprentice is wrapping the house. Which way of installing flexible wall underlay is correct?

- A Run it vertically, with 50 mm laps at the joins.
- B Lap lower sheets over upper sheets so the staples hold better.
- C Stop it at the top of the bottom plate so it doesn't sit in the cavity.
- D Run it horizontally, upper sheets over lower, with 75 mm horizontal laps and 150 mm laps over studs at vertical joins.

---

54 RULE CHECK

How far must flexible wall underlay extend below the bottom plate or bearer?

- A It should finish flush with the bottom of the plate
- B 20 mm
- C 35 mm
- D 50 mm

---

55 SITE SCENARIO

You're cladding a house in an Extra High wind zone. What does E2/AS1 require behind the cladding?

- A A rigid underlay, such as 7 mm H3 plywood or 6 mm fibre cement, with a drained cavity.
- B Flexible building wrap and a drained cavity, the same as any other zone.
- C Direct-fixed cladding over two layers of building wrap.
- D Nothing extra. Extra High is treated the same as Very High.

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56 RULE CHECK

What's an acceptable air seal between a window reveal and the wrapped opening?

- A Nothing. The head flashing keeps the water out.
- B Fibreglass insulation packed into the gap
- C Flashing tape across the gap on the outside face
- D Self-expanding polyurethane foam or sealant, installed over a closed-cell PEF backing rod

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57 RULE CHECK

Why does E2/AS1 want a PEF backing rod behind self-expanding foam in a window air seal?

- A To stop the foam expanding out to the exterior and forming a moisture bridge to the inside
- B To hold the window square while the foam cures
- C To add insulation around the window
- D To give the window fixings something to bite into

---

58 RULE CHECK

Once a window is installed, what's the minimum overlap of the window's facing flange over the cladding or back flashing at the sill?

- A 5 mm
- B 8 mm
- C 10 mm
- D 15 mm

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59 RULE CHECK

In a High wind zone, what's the minimum lap of a window head flashing up under the cladding above?

- A 15 mm
- B 35 mm
- C 60 mm
- D 75 mm

---

60 RULE CHECK

What gap should there be between the head flashing and the bottom edge of the cladding above it?

- A None. Seal the cladding to the flashing.
- B 5 mm (10 mm maximum), as an anti-capillary gap
- C 20 mm, for cavity ventilation
- D 2 mm

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61 SITE SCENARIO

The client wants an aluminium window with a raking (sloped) head in a weatherboard wall. Can you use the standard E2/AS1 window details?

- A Yes, with a standard head flashing.
- B Yes, as long as the slope is under 15°.
- C Yes, as long as the window is under 13.5 m².
- D No. E2/AS1 window details only cover horizontal heads, so a sloped head needs specific design.

---

62 SITE SCENARIO

On a house with direct-fixed weatherboards, you check the window sill flashings before the cladding goes on. Which of these is a fault?

- A The sill flashing slopes back towards the building.
- B The sill flashing is flat.
- C The sill flashing extends past the window's condensation channel.
- D The sill is supported as the window manufacturer specifies.

---

63 RULE CHECK

How far can a drained cavity run continuously up a wall before an inter-storey flashing is needed?

- A One storey or 3.5 m, whichever is less
- B Two storeys or 7 m, whichever is less
- C Three storeys or 10 m
- D There's no limit

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64 RULE CHECK

On a slab-on-ground house with direct-fixed weatherboards, how should the bottom of the cladding finish against the slab?

- A Flush with the top of the slab
- B Overlapping the slab by 20 mm and sealed to it
- C Overlapping the slab by 100 mm and fixed into the slab edge
- D Overlapping the slab by 50 mm, held off the slab face by at least 6 mm

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65 RULE CHECK

On a house with a suspended timber floor, how far must the wall cladding extend below the bearer or lowest part of the floor framing?

- A 20 mm
- B 35 mm
- C 50 mm
- D 100 mm

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66 SITE SCENARIO

A lean-to roof meets the wall of the house. What clearance must the bottom of the wall cladding have above the roofing or apron flashing?

- A 10 mm
- B 20 mm
- C 35 mm
- D 50 mm

---

67 RULE CHECK

In a Medium wind zone with a 25° roof, what total upstand does a metal roof-to-wall flashing need?

- A 90 mm
- B 110 mm
- C 125 mm
- D 150 mm

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68 RULE CHECK

Where a butyl or EPDM membrane deck meets a wall, how far must the membrane lap up under the cladding above?

- A 35 mm
- B 75 mm
- C 115 mm
- D 150 mm

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69 RULE CHECK

For an enclosed (membrane) deck, what's the minimum step down from the door threshold to the finished deck surface?

- A 25 mm
- B 50 mm
- C 100 mm
- D 150 mm

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70 RULE CHECK

For a slatted timber deck next to the house, what's the minimum gap between the external wall and the first decking slat?

- A 5 mm
- B 12 mm
- C 20 mm
- D 35 mm

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71 SITE SCENARIO

You're building a cantilevered slatted timber deck off a first-floor living room. How far below the door threshold must the deck surface be?

- A It can be level with the threshold
- B 25 mm
- C 50 mm
- D 100 mm

---

72 SITE SCENARIO

Which membrane deck design is within E2/AS1?

- A A 35 m² deck with a 1:40 fall, no steps, and no downpipes discharging onto it
- B A 50 m² deck with a 1:60 fall
- C A 30 m² deck with an integral roof garden
- D A 40 m² deck with a downpipe discharging straight onto it

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73 RULE CHECK

What's the minimum fall for a butyl or EPDM membrane roof under E2/AS1?

- A 1:100 (about 0.6°)
- B 1:60 (about 1°)
- C 1:40 (1.5°)
- D 1:30 (2°)

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74 SITE SCENARIO

A client wants corrugated steel on a 5° lean-to roof, 6 m long with no end laps. What do you tell them?

- A That's fine. Any metal roof can go down to 3°.
- B Corrugate needs at least 8°, so use a trough profile or a trapezoidal profile with crests 27 mm or higher (3° minimum).
- C Corrugate needs at least 15°.
- D That's fine, as long as it's fixed at every crest.

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75 RULE CHECK

What's the maximum moisture content of timber framing in an insulated house when the interior linings go on?

- A 12%
- B 16%
- C 20%
- D 24%

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76 RULE CHECK

What level change does E2/AS1 require at the vehicle door of a garage attached to the house?

- A None, if the door is a weather-resisting sectional door
- B 12 mm
- C 50 mm minimum total level change between the garage floor and the exterior paving
- D 100 mm

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77 RULE CHECK

What's the maximum spacing of dwangs (nogs) behind direct-fixed vertical weatherboards?

- A 480 mm
- B 600 mm
- C 800 mm
- D 1350 mm

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78 RULE CHECK

In an Extra High wind zone, what does E2/AS1 require for flashing upstands?

- A Both hooks or hems and an extra 25 mm of upstand
- B Either hooks and hems, or an extra 25 mm of upstand
- C Sealant along the top of the upstand instead of hooks
- D An extra 50 mm of upstand, with no hooks needed

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79 SITE SCENARIO

A three-storey house on a sloping site measures 10.8 m from the lowest adjacent ground level to the ridge. Can E2/AS1 be used for its weathertightness details?

- A Yes. It's only three storeys.
- B No. E2/AS1 is limited to 10 m, measured from the lowest adjacent ground level to the highest point of the roof.
- C Yes. The ridge doesn't count.
- D Yes. Height is measured from the average ground level.

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80 RULE CHECK

A building consent application for a new house is lodged in September 2026. Which edition of E2/AS1 can it use to show compliance?

- A The 3rd edition (Amendment 10), because most designers still use it
- B Either edition, the designer's choice
- C Whichever edition the council prefers
- D The 4th edition. The 3rd edition could only be used for applications lodged before 1 August 2026.

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81 SITE SCENARIO

A window opening is wider than the cavity batten spacing. What must you leave above the head flashing at the bottom of the vertical cavity battens?

- A Nothing. Seal the battens down onto the flashing.
- B A horizontal batten across the full width.
- C A 50 mm gap filled with vermin mesh.
- D A gap of at least 10 mm between the bottom of the battens and the flashing, so air can move between cavities

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82 SITE SCENARIO

The studs are at 600 mm centres, the wall underlay is flexible building wrap, and the cladding goes on a drained cavity. What else does E2/AS1 require?

- A An intermediate restraint, such as polypropylene tape or galvanised wire at 300 mm centres, to stop the wrap and insulation bulging into the cavity
- B A second layer of wrap
- C Thicker cavity battens
- D Nothing more

---

83 RULE CHECK

In wind zones up to Very High, what forms the barrier to airflow in an external wall?

- A The building wrap on its own
- B The interior linings, with all joints stopped
- C The cavity battens
- D The wall insulation

---

84 RULE CHECK

Under B2, how long must a flashing that is completely hidden behind masonry veneer last?

- A 5 years
- B 15 years
- C 50 years
- D 100 years

---

85 RULE CHECK

What minimum cavity does E2/AS1 assume for traditional clay brick masonry veneer?

- A 20 mm
- B 25 mm
- C 40 mm
- D 75 mm

BRACING

Bracing demand, wind and earthquake zones, bracing lines, elements, hold-downs and diaphragms. Questions 86–121.

86 RULE CHECK

On a bracing calculation sheet, how many bracing units (BUs) equal 1 kN of bracing resistance?

- A 5
- B 10
- C 20
- D 50

87 CALCULATION

For a single-storey house you calculate bracing demand along the building: wind gives 380 BUs and earthquake gives 290 BUs. How much bracing must the walls along the building provide?

- A 290 BUs
- B 335 BUs (the average)
- C 380 BUs
- D 670 BUs (the total)

88 SITE SCENARIO

Your bracing plan has across-the-building bracing lines at 0 m, 4.2 m and 11.0 m along the house. There's no ceiling diaphragm and no dragon ties. What's wrong?

- A The 6.8 m gap is more than the 6 m maximum, so another bracing line is needed between 4.2 m and 11.0 m.
- B The lines have to be evenly spaced.
- C The first line can't be on an external wall.
- D Nothing. Bracing line spacing isn't limited.

89 RULE CHECK

Where dragon ties are installed to NZS 3604, what's the maximum spacing between wall bracing lines?

- A 6 m
- B 7.5 m
- C 9 m
- D 12 m

90 RULE CHECK

With a plasterboard ceiling diaphragm designed to NZS 3604, how far apart can the supporting bracing lines be?

- A 6 m
- B 7.5 m
- C 9 m
- D 12 m

91 RULE CHECK

What's the minimum bracing capacity required on a bracing line that runs along an external wall?

- A The greatest of 100 BUs, 15 BUs per metre of external wall, and 50% of the total demand divided by the number of lines in that direction
- B 100 BUs, whatever the wall length or demand
- C 10% of the total demand in that direction
- D 50 BUs

---

92 CALCULATION

Across the building, total demand is 600 BUs spread over 4 bracing lines. Line B is an internal wall. What's the minimum bracing for line B?

- A 75 BUs
- B 100 BUs
- C 150 BUs
- D 300 BUs

---

93 CALCULATION

Total demand in one direction is 1000 BUs over 3 bracing lines. Line A runs along a 12 m external wall. What's the minimum bracing for line A?

- A 100 BUs
- B 167 BUs
- C 180 BUs
- D 333 BUs

---

94 SITE SCENARIO

Two parallel walls 1.5 m apart both carry bracing elements. Can you count them as one bracing line?

- A No. Every wall has to be its own bracing line.
- B Only if the elements are the same type.
- C Only if they're within 600 mm of each other.
- D Yes. Parallel elements up to 2 m apart can be counted on one line.

---

95 SITE SCENARIO

On a gable end wall, a plasterboard bracing element stops at a row of nogs at ceiling height instead of running to the top plate. Is that acceptable?

- A Yes. Nogs give plenty of fixing.
- B Yes, as long as you add extra screws along the nogs.
- C No. Gable end walls can't be used for bracing.
- D No, unless a continuous member, such as a ribbon plate fixed across the studs above the nogs or a GIBFix Angle, is installed at the ceiling line.

---

96 RULE CHECK

In a GIB EzyBrace element code such as BL1-H, what does the H mean?

- A Specific panel hold-down fixings are needed at each end of the element
- B For High wind zones only
- C For heavy roofs
- D Sheets are fixed horizontally

---

97 RULE CHECK

What does the bracing element code GS1-N describe?

- A GIB Standard plasterboard on one side, with no specific hold-down fixings
- B GIB Standard plasterboard on one side, 1 m long, nailed
- C GIB Braceline on one side with nominal fixings
- D Structural grade 1 timber with no nogs

---

98 RULE CHECK

A BL1-H bracing element is on a concrete slab. What's needed at each end of the element?

- A Standard bottom plate fixings at 900 mm centres
- B A 100 mm nail through the plate into the slab
- C Construction adhesive under the plate
- D A hold-down with at least 15 kN characteristic uplift capacity and a 50 × 50 × 3 mm washer, within 80 mm of the end of the element (or a GIB HandiBrac)

---

99 RULE CHECK

An H-type bracing element sits on a timber floor. What hold-down does GIB specify at each end?

- A Two 100 mm nails into the joist
- B A metal strap only, with no screw
- C 10 g screws at 300 mm centres
- D A 12 × 150 mm galvanised coach screw with a 50 × 50 × 3 mm washer, within 80 mm of the end, into a solid joist or block

---

100 RULE CHECK

For N-type bracing elements on a timber floor, how is the bottom plate fixed down?

- A Pairs of 100 × 3.75 mm hand-driven nails, or three 90 × 3.15 mm power-driven nails, at 600 mm centres
- B 10 g screws at 1200 mm centres
- C Construction adhesive only
- D One 75 mm nail at 900 mm centres

---

101 SITE SCENARIO

The bracing calculation passes on total BUs, but almost all of the bracing is in walls at one end of the house. Is that a problem?

- A No. Total BUs is all that matters.
- B Yes. Uneven bracing lets the building twist (torsion) in an earthquake, so spread bracing evenly and as close as practical to external corners.
- C No, as long as hold-downs are used.
- D Only in High wind zones.

---

102 RULE CHECK

NZS 3604 earthquake bracing demand is based on an earthquake with what chance of being exceeded during a 50-year design life?

- A 2%
- B 10%
- C 25%
- D 50%

---

103 RULE CHECK

What's the maximum design wind speed for the High wind zone in NZS 3604?

- A 32 m/s
- B 37 m/s
- C 44 m/s
- D 50 m/s

---

104 SITE SCENARIO

Working through the wind zone steps, your site comes out above 55 m/s. What happens?

- A The site is beyond Extra High and outside NZS 3604, so it needs specific engineering design.
- B Add 20% to the bracing demand.
- C Use a rigid underlay and carry on with NZS 3604.
- D Use the Extra High wind zone tables.

---

105 RULE CHECK

Which of these is NOT used to work out a site's wind zone under NZS 3604?

- A Wind region (A or W)
- B Ground roughness (urban or open terrain)
- C Site exposure (sheltered or exposed) and topographic class
- D Soil class

---

106 RULE CHECK

NZS 3604 divides New Zealand into four earthquake zones. Which is the lowest-risk zone?

- A Zone 1
- B Zone 2
- C Zone 3
- D Zone 4

---

107 RULE CHECK

The soil class for a site hasn't been established. Which soil class should you use when calculating earthquake bracing demand?

- A Class A (rock)
- B Class C (shallow soil)
- C Class D
- D Class E (deep or soft soil)

---

108 RULE CHECK

Which of these does NOT change the bracing demand calculated for a house?

- A The wind zone
- B The type of plasterboard used in the bracing elements
- C The weight of the roof and wall claddings
- D The earthquake zone and soil class

---

109 RULE CHECK

A client switches from a light metal roof to heavy concrete tiles. Which bracing demand goes up the most?

- A Wind demand only
- B Only the subfloor wind demand
- C Neither. Roof weight doesn't affect bracing.
- D Earthquake demand, because the building is heavier

---

110 RULE CHECK

On a two-storey house, why does the ground floor need more bracing than the upper floor?

- A The ground floor walls resist the loads from the upper storey and roof as well as their own.
- B Ground floor walls are internal, so they're weaker.
- C It doesn't. Both floors need the same.
- D The ground floor walls are taller.

---

111 RULE CHECK

On a piled timber floor, which of these does NOT provide subfloor bracing?

- A Anchor piles
- B Ordinary piles
- C Cantilever piles
- D Braced pile systems

---

112 RULE CHECK

What's the maximum spacing between subfloor bracing lines?

- A 3 m
- B 5 m
- C 6 m
- D 7.5 m

---

113 RULE CHECK

What bracing rating does NZS 3604 give one anchor pile (wind / earthquake)?

- A 70 / 30 BUs
- B 120 / 120 BUs
- C 160 / 120 BUs
- D 200 / 160 BUs

---

114 SITE SCENARIO

The electrician wants a 150 × 150 mm hole for a data cabinet in the middle of a GS1-N bracing element. What do you tell them?

- A Fine. Small holes don't affect bracing.
- B Fine, as long as it's 90 mm from the edge.
- C Fill the hole with an offcut afterwards.
- D No. Openings over 90 × 90 mm (or 100 mm round) go outside the bracing element, or the bracing moves to the other side of the wall.

---

115 SITE SCENARIO

The client asks for a new window where the consented plans show a bracing element. What do you do?

- A Get the designer to recheck the bracing, and get the change approved by the BCA (as a minor variation or amendment) before building it.
- B Swap to a higher-rated element somewhere else and carry on.
- C Build it and tell the inspector at the final.
- D Just move the bracing element along the wall.

---

116 CALCULATION

A bracing element is rated 70 BUs per metre for wind. How many wind BUs does a 1.8 m length provide?

- A 70 BUs
- B 112 BUs
- C 126 BUs
- D 168 BUs

---

117 CALCULATION

Bracing line C has two elements: 1.2 m rated 60 BUs/m and 2.4 m rated 100 BUs/m. What's the total capacity of line C?

- A 160 BUs
- B 252 BUs
- C 312 BUs
- D 384 BUs

---

118 RULE CHECK

What shape and size limits apply to a plasterboard ceiling diaphragm under NZS 3604?

- A It must be square.
- B No more than 12 m long, no longer than twice its width, with bracing lines on all four sides.
- C Up to 20 m long, any width.
- D Any shape, as long as the area is under 100 m².

---

119 CALCULATION

A ceiling diaphragm is 10 m long and 6 m wide. What's the minimum bracing for each 6 m end wall that supports it?

- A 90 BUs
- B 100 BUs
- C 150 BUs
- D 300 BUs

---

120 RULE CHECK

Under the Building Product Specifications (2025), what rating can generic plasterboard bracing use for a wall at least 1.2 m long, fully lined with 10 or 13 mm plasterboard?

- A 10 BUs/m per lined face
- B 25 BUs/m per lined face
- C 50 BUs/m per lined face
- D 100 BUs/m per lined face

---

121 RULE CHECK

A wall bracing line rated over 100 BUs has a joint in its top plate. What does NZS 3604 require at the joint?

- A Nothing, as long as the joint is over a stud
- B A 3 kN connection
- C A 6 kN connection, or a staggered double top plate
- D A bolted steel plate

FOUNDATIONS, FRAMING & TIMBER

Good ground, piles, subfloors, slabs, timber grades and treatment, fixings and span tables. Questions 122–151.

122 RULE CHECK

What does NZS 3604 mean by good ground?

- A Soil or rock that can permanently withstand an ultimate bearing capacity of 300 kPa (100 kPa allowable), excluding soft, expansive or unstable ground
- B Ground a builder has dug and found firm
- C Any ground that has been compacted with a plate compactor
- D Any natural ground that isn't topsoil

123 RULE CHECK

Using a Scala penetrometer to check for good ground, what result do you need down to a depth of twice the footing width?

- A At least 2 blows per 100 mm
- B At least 3 blows per 100 mm
- C At least 5 blows per 100 mm
- D At least 10 blows per 100 mm

124 RULE CHECK

What does NZS 3603 cover?

- A Timber-framed buildings
- B Concrete masonry buildings
- C Timber and wood-based products for use in building
- D Timber structures (engineering design of timber)

125 RULE CHECK

Which structural grades do the NZS 3604:2011 span tables use?

- A SG6, SG8 and SG10 (plus wet-use grades)
- B MSG8, VSG8 and MSG10 only
- C H1.2 and H3.2
- D No.1 Framing and Building grade

126 RULE CHECK

What hazard class of treatment is required for deck joists and decking that are exposed to the weather but not in the ground?

- A H1.2
- B H3.1
- C H3.2
- D H4

127 RULE CHECK

What treatment hazard class do timber house piles need?

- A H3.2
- B H4
- C H5
- D H6

---

128 RULE CHECK

What treatment do cavity battens need under the current Building Product Specifications?

- A None. They're protected behind the cladding.
- B H1.2
- C H3.1
- D H4

---

129 RULE CHECK

You're looking at a stack of pink-coloured framing timber. What does the colour usually tell you?

- A It's untreated timber, primed for painting.
- B It's boron-treated H1.2 framing timber.
- C It's H3.2 treated for exterior use.
- D It's been kiln-dried to below 12%.

---

130 SITE SCENARIO

You need to shorten an H5 timber pile. What's the right way to do it?

- A Cut the bottom off, so the treated top stays clean.
- B Cut from the top, treat the cut surface with a suitable preservative, and never put a cut end in the ground.
- C No special care. H5 timber is treated right through.
- D Paint the cut with acrylic primer.

---

131 RULE CHECK

What's the minimum size of a square timber house pile under NZS 3604?

- A 100 × 100 mm
- B 125 × 125 mm
- C 150 × 150 mm
- D 200 × 200 mm

---

132 RULE CHECK

What does an ordinary pile do?

- A Resists horizontal loads from wind and earthquakes
- B Holds the floor down against uplift
- C Acts as a braced pile when the floor is under 600 mm high
- D Carries vertical loads only, with no bracing value

---

133 RULE CHECK

What's the minimum footing depth for an anchor pile?

- A 200 mm
- B 450 mm
- C 600 mm
- D 900 mm

---

134 CALCULATION

A floor needs subfloor ventilation. The floor area is 120 m². What's the minimum total net vent area under NZS 3604?

- A 42,000 mm²
- B 350,000 mm²
- C 420,000 mm²
- D 700,000 mm²

---

135 RULE CHECK

Where should subfloor vents be placed?

- A No more than 1.8 m apart and within 750 mm of each corner, so air flows through the whole subfloor
- B At least 3 m apart, away from corners
- C Anywhere, as long as the total area is right
- D Only on the side facing the prevailing wind

---

136 SITE SCENARIO

On an infill section, you can't fit enough subfloor vents along one side of the house. What's the NZS 3604 fallback?

- A Leave it. Ventilation isn't critical.
- B Fit a fan and carry on.
- C Fill the subfloor with gravel.
- D Lay a 0.25 mm polythene ground vapour barrier over the whole ground surface, which lets the vent area drop to 700 mm² per m² of floor.

---

137 RULE CHECK

What does NZS 3604's 450 mm subfloor clearance relate to?

- A The clearance to the underside of floor joists for access under the floor
- B The clearance from ground to the underside of the bearers
- C The minimum height of every pile above ground
- D The minimum height of the subfloor vents

---

138 RULE CHECK

What's the minimum damp-proof membrane (DPM) under a slab-on-ground?

- A 0.1 mm polythene
- B 0.15 mm polythene
- C 0.25 mm (250 micron) polythene, with laps taped
- D No DPM is needed over a granular base

---

139 RULE CHECK

What's the maximum depth of compacted hardfill under an NZS 3604 slab?

- A 300 mm
- B 450 mm
- C 600 mm
- D 900 mm

---

140 RULE CHECK

Under B1/AS1 2nd edition (from July 2025), can an NZS 3604 house slab be unreinforced or use fibre reinforcement only?

- A Yes, unreinforced slabs are fine on good ground.
- B No. All slabs must be reinforced with ductile Grade 500E mesh (at least 2.27 kg/m²); the unreinforced and fibre-only options were removed.
- C Only in earthquake zone 1.
- D Yes, fibre reinforcement can replace mesh.

---

141 RULE CHECK

What's the minimum concrete cover to reinforcing where the concrete is cast directly against the ground?

- A 30 mm
- B 50 mm
- C 75 mm
- D 100 mm

---

142 RULE CHECK

A house is being built 300 m from a harbour. What's the minimum concrete strength under NZS 3604?

- A 17.5 MPa
- B 20 MPa
- C 25 MPa
- D 30 MPa

---

143 RULE CHECK

Under NZS 3604, which exposure zone covers sites within 500 m of the coast (including harbours) or 100 m of tidal estuaries?

- A Zone B
- B Zone C
- C Zone D
- D Zone E

---

144 SITE SCENARIO

You're building an exposed deck in exposure zone D. What fixings should you use for the structural connections, like joist hangers and bolts?

- A Stainless steel (grade 304 or better)
- B Hot-dip galvanised steel
- C Aluminium
- D Electroplated (zinc-plated) steel

---

145 RULE CHECK

Which fixing should you NOT use against copper-treated timber (ACQ or copper azole) in an exposed location?

- A 304 stainless steel
- B Silicon bronze
- C 316 stainless steel
- D Hot-dip galvanised steel

---

146 RULE CHECK

What's the maximum stud spacing allowed by the NZS 3604 wall framing tables?

- A 400 mm
- B 450 mm
- C 600 mm
- D 800 mm

---

147 RULE CHECK

What does loaded dimension mean in NZS 3604 span tables?

- A The length of the member between supports
- B A measure of the weight of construction the member supports, such as half the joist spans either side of a bearer
- C The depth of the member
- D The total load in kilonewtons

---

148 CALCULATION

A bearer supports floor joists spanning 3.6 m on one side and 2.4 m on the other. What's its loaded dimension?

- A 1.2 m
- B 2.4 m
- C 3.0 m
- D 6.0 m

---

149 RULE CHECK

Which of these do you NOT need when choosing a stud size from the NZS 3604 stud tables?

- A Roof weight (light or heavy)
- B Wind zone
- C Loaded dimension, stud height and spacing
- D Earthquake zone

---

150 RULE CHECK

How soon should shrinkage control joints in a new slab be saw cut?

- A After 7 days, once the concrete has hardened
- B As soon as the concrete can be cut cleanly: typically within 24 hours in warm weather (over 20°C) or 48 hours in cooler weather
- C Any time before the floor coverings go down
- D Before the concrete is poured

---

151 RULE CHECK

NZS 3604:2011 is cited in B1/AS1 with modifications. What's its status in October 2026?

- A NZS 3604:2011 is still current. A draft revision went out for public comment in 2026 but can't be used yet.
- B It's no longer an acceptable solution.
- C It only applies to single-storey houses now.
- D It was replaced by a new edition in 2025.

BUILDING ACT, CODE & CONSENTS

Building Code clauses, ways to comply, consents, inspections, variations, exemptions and CCCs. Questions 152–183.

152 RULE CHECK

Which statement best describes the purpose of the Building Act 2004?

- A To ensure people can use buildings safely and without endangering their health
- B To set out the mandatory performance criteria for building work
- C To allow for continuing innovation in building
- D To make sure the most cost-efficient materials are used

153 RULE CHECK

Which statement best describes the Building Code?

- A A collection of standard New Zealand building practices
- B Step-by-step rules for designing and constructing buildings
- C The complaints procedure for faulty building work
- D The mandatory performance criteria that all building work must meet

154 RULE CHECK

Which parts of the Building Code are mandatory?

- A The objectives, functional requirements and performance criteria
- B The Acceptable Solutions and Verification Methods
- C Only the performance criteria
- D Only the Acceptable Solutions

155 RULE CHECK

What is an alternative solution?

- A A provision of Australian building legislation
- B A design the BCA must accept without question
- C A design that differs from an Acceptable Solution or Verification Method but still shows how the work will comply with the Building Code
- D A plain-language summary of a Verification Method

156 RULE CHECK

A cladding product has a current BRANZ Appraisal. How does a BCA have to treat it?

- A It must accept the product as complying, like a CodeMark certificate.
- B It must reject it, because appraisals aren't recognised.
- C The appraisal is evidence the BCA can consider, but it isn't deemed to comply, so the BCA decides whether it's satisfied.
- D It must send it to MBIE for a determination.

157 RULE CHECK

Which document, first issued in July 2025, sets out product standards and specifications that must be used together with an Acceptable Solution, not on their own?

- A The Building Product Specifications
- B NZS 3604:2011
- C The Building Code
- D The LBP Handbook

---

158 RULE CHECK

Who is responsible for making sure a building consent application is made?

- A The consulting engineer
- B The owner
- C The Site LBP
- D The Design LBP

---

159 SITE SCENARIO

The client wants you to start framing next week. The consent has been lodged but not yet issued. What do you tell them?

- A Start now. The consent is just paperwork and it'll come through.
- B Start on anything that isn't restricted building work.
- C Start, as long as the council is told.
- D You can't start the consented work until the building consent has been granted and issued.

---

160 RULE CHECK

How long does a BCA have to grant or refuse a building consent application?

- A 10 working days
- B 20 working days, with the clock stopped while it waits for further information it has asked for
- C 20 calendar days
- D 30 working days, with no stoppages

---

161 RULE CHECK

A building consent was issued 14 months ago, but no work has started and no extension was agreed. What's its status?

- A It's still valid for 5 years.
- B It has lapsed, because work didn't start within 12 months of the consent being issued.
- C It's valid until the code compliance certificate is issued.
- D It's valid as long as the fees were paid.

---

162 RULE CHECK

Who certifies that completed building work complies with the building consent?

- A The Site LBP
- B The owner
- C The building consent authority, by issuing a code compliance certificate
- D The Design LBP

---

163 RULE CHECK

Who is responsible for applying for the code compliance certificate when the work is finished?

- A The building consent authority
- B The consulting engineer
- C The carpenter who did the restricted building work
- D The owner

---

164 RULE CHECK

Since August 2025, what inspection timeframe are BCAs measured against?

- A At least 80% of inspections done within 3 working days of the requested date
- B Inspections within 10 working days
- C No timeframe applies
- D Every inspection within 24 hours of booking

---

165 RULE CHECK

What is a minor variation to a building consent?

- A Any change the builder thinks is small
- B A change that doesn't need to be recorded
- C A change that doesn't significantly depart from the consent, approved by the BCA before it's built and recorded in writing
- D A change that is approved after the work is done

---

166 SITE SCENARIO

The specified cladding is out of stock and the supplier offers a different brand. When can the substitution be treated as a minor variation?

- A Whenever the new product is cheaper
- B Whenever the builder signs off on it
- C Never. All product substitutions need a full amendment.
- D When it gives equivalent performance, is unlikely to affect compliance of other work, and the consequence of failure isn't significantly worse

---

167 RULE CHECK

What is a notice to fix?

- A A formal notice from the BCA or council requiring someone to fix building work that breaches the Act or regulations
- B An instruction from the designer
- C An insurance claim form
- D A request from the owner to repair a defect

---

168 RULE CHECK

What is a certificate of acceptance?

- A A certificate that a design LBP gives with a consent application
- B A certificate the council can issue for building work done without a required building consent, if it's satisfied the work complies
- C A certificate from the supplier that a product is suitable
- D The certificate issued at the end of a consented job

---

169 RULE CHECK

What is a project information memorandum (PIM)?

- A A record of work given by an LBP
- B A list of required inspections
- C Information from the council about a property and the proposed work, such as hazards, services and other approvals needed
- D The approved consent plans

---

170 RULE CHECK

When do you need a resource consent?

- A When the district plan (or a regional plan) requires one for the activity
- B When the site is within 10 km of a national park
- C Never, if the work complies with the Building Code
- D When the project involves a Category 3 building

---

171 RULE CHECK

Under Building Code clause B2, how long must wall cladding (part of the building envelope) last with normal maintenance?

- A 5 years
- B 15 years
- C 50 years
- D The full life of the building, at least 100 years

---

172 RULE CHECK

Under clause B2, which of these must last at least 50 years?

- A Paint finishes
- B Interior wall linings
- C Kitchen fixtures
- D Wall framing and its fixings

---

173 RULE CHECK

Which Building Code clause covers barriers to stop people falling from decks and stairs?

- A B1 Structure
- B F4 Safety from falling
- C E2 External moisture
- D D1 Access routes

---

174 SITE SCENARIO

A client wants a deck that sits 1.2 m above the ground at its highest point. It's exempt from building consent. Does it need a barrier?

- A No. Exempt work doesn't have to meet the Building Code.
- B No. Barriers are only needed above 1.5 m.
- C Yes. All building work must meet the Building Code, and clause F4 needs a barrier where someone could fall 1 m or more.
- D Only if the council asks for one.

---

175 RULE CHECK

Which Building Code clause covers keeping rain and groundwater out of a building?

- A E1 Surface water
- B E2 External moisture
- C E3 Internal moisture
- D G4 Ventilation

---

176 RULE CHECK

Which of these must you know about all building work, including work exempt from consent?

- A It must still comply with the Building Code.
- B Only an LBP can do it.
- C The council must inspect it.
- D It doesn't need to meet the Building Code.

---

177 RULE CHECK

Since 15 January 2026, what's the maximum floor area of a small stand-alone dwelling (granny flat) that can be built without a building consent?

- A 30 m²
- B 50 m²
- C 70 m²
- D 90 m²

---

178 RULE CHECK

Who can do the building work on an exempt granny flat under Schedule 1A?

- A Anyone, because it doesn't need a consent
- B Only the owner
- C Only a registered architect
- D Licensed building practitioners (doing or supervising the work), with plumbing, drainlaying, gas and electrical work done by authorised people

---

179 RULE CHECK

Under H1/AS1 6th edition (from 27 November 2025), how is compliance for house insulation shown?

- A By the schedule method only
- B By choosing R-values from a table, with no calculation
- C H1 no longer applies to houses
- D By the calculation method (or modelling); the schedule method was removed

---

180 RULE CHECK

In the H1/AS1 calculation method, what roof R-value does the reference building use?

- A R2.9
- B R3.3
- C R4.0
- D R6.6

---

181 RULE CHECK

Who issues the certificate for electrical work that the BCA needs before it can issue a CCC?

- A The licensed electrical worker who did the work
- B The builder
- C The Site LBP
- D The BCA's building inspector

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182 RULE CHECK

What's the status of proportionate liability for building defects in October 2026?

- A It became law in 2025.
- B It applies only to LBPs.
- C It isn't law yet. The Building Amendment Bill introduced in June 2026 proposes it, and it's still before Parliament.
- D It applies only to council inspectors.

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183 RULE CHECK

What must be kept on site during consented building work?

- A Nothing. The council holds the documents.
- B The approved (stamped) consent documents, including any amendments and the inspection schedule
- C Only the engineer's producer statements
- D Only the builder's own drawings

LICENSING, ETHICS & DISCIPLINE

Licence classes, the assessment, renewal, skills maintenance, the Code of Ethics and the Board. Questions 184–208.

184 RULE CHECK

What is the main aim of the Licensed Building Practitioner scheme?

- A To protect consumers, lift practitioners' competence and make LBPs accountable for their work
- B To replace building consents
- C To license every trade on a building site
- D To set the price of building work

185 RULE CHECK

Who decides licence applications and renewals, keeps the public register and sets the skills maintenance requirements?

- A The Building Practitioners Board
- B The Minister for Building and Construction
- C The Registrar of Building Practitioners
- D The local council

186 RULE CHECK

Which of these is NOT an LBP licence class?

- A Foundations
- B Plumbing
- C Site
- D External Plastering

187 RULE CHECK

How many areas of practice does the Carpentry licence have?

- A None. Carpentry is a single licence with no areas of practice.
- B Two
- C Three, one for each building category
- D Seven

188 RULE CHECK

Which of these is one of the four Carpentry licence competencies?

- A Carry out planning and scheduling for carpentry work
- B Manage the design process for Category 2 buildings
- C Inspect building work on behalf of a BCA
- D Prepare architectural drawings for building consent

189 RULE CHECK

Under the standard (experience) application for a Carpentry licence, what happens at the assessment?

- A A three-hour written exam at a polytechnic
- B A practical test on a training site
- C An online multiple-choice test only
- D An assessor reviews your evidence, interviews you about the competencies (recorded, usually by video call) and phones your referees

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190 RULE CHECK

Which of these people can be a referee for your LBP application?

- A Your partner, who has watched you work for years
- B A technically credible person, preferably an LBP, who has seen you do RBW in the last 5 years and isn't family
- C Your brother, who is also an LBP
- D A client who hired you once

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191 RULE CHECK

You hold the New Zealand Certificate in Carpentry (Level 4). How does that change your licence application?

- A You're licensed automatically, with no assessment.
- B It makes no difference.
- C You can use the streamlined (qualified) pathway, but you still need referees and an assessment interview.
- D You only need to pay the fee.

---

192 RULE CHECK

How often must an LBP renew their licence?

- A Every year, by replying to the Registrar and paying the fee within 20 working days
- B Every 2 years
- C Never. Licences are for life.
- D Every 5 years

---

193 RULE CHECK

What skills maintenance must a Carpentry LBP complete in each two-year cycle?

- A Nothing, once you're licensed
- B 12 hours (points) of elective activities, 2 on-the-job learning examples, and the specified Codewords articles and quizzes
- C 40 hours of courses
- D A refresher exam

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194 RULE CHECK

Your contact details change. How long do you have to tell the Registrar?

- A 3 months
- B At your next renewal
- C 10 working days
- D 12 months

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195 RULE CHECK

When did the Code of Ethics for LBPs become enforceable?

- A 1 March 2012
- B 1 January 2015
- C 25 October 2022
- D 15 January 2026

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196 RULE CHECK

Which of these is one of the four principles of the LBP Code of Ethics?

- A Maximise profit for your business
- B Always use the cheapest compliant product
- C Work only for homeowners
- D Take responsibility for your actions

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197 SITE SCENARIO

A supplier delay means the cladding will arrive three weeks late. What does the Code of Ethics expect of you?

- A Say nothing until the cladding arrives.
- B Wait until the client asks.
- C Blame the supplier if the client complains.
- D Tell the client about the delay as soon as it becomes apparent.

---

198 SITE SCENARIO

A client asks you to swap the consented cladding for a cheaper, non-equivalent product without telling the council. What do you do?

- A Refuse to change it without BCA approval, and explain the risks and the legal requirements to the client.
- B Do it, but don't put it on your record of work.
- C Do it and get the council to sign off later.
- D Do it, because the Code says you must follow your client's instructions.

---

199 RULE CHECK

Which of these is a standard in the LBP Code of Ethics?

- A You must accept every job you're offered.
- B You must price work fairly and reasonably.
- C You must keep all disputes confidential from the Board.
- D You must always quote the lowest price.

---

200 SITE SCENARIO

On a multi-trade site you see another trade's worker repeatedly working on a roof edge with no fall protection. What does the Code of Ethics expect?

- A Ignore it. It's not your crew.
- B Mention it at the end of the job.
- C Take responsibility for health and safety and report the unsafe behaviour.
- D Only act if you're the main contractor.

---

201 RULE CHECK

Which of these can lead to disciplinary action by the Building Practitioners Board?

- A Failing to provide a record of work
- B Getting a licence by giving false information
- C Supervising RBW without enough oversight of the work
- D All of the above

---

202 RULE CHECK

Which of these can the Board do if a complaint against an LBP is upheld?

- A Order the LBP to do training
- B Cancel the LBP's licence
- C Suspend the licence for up to 12 months, or restrict the work the LBP can do
- D All of the above

---

203 RULE CHECK

What's the maximum fine the Building Practitioners Board can order under section 318 of the Building Act?

- A $1,000
- B $10,000
- C $50,000
- D $150,000

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204 RULE CHECK

Who can make a complaint about an LBP to the Building Practitioners Board?

- A Only the homeowner
- B Only the council
- C Only another LBP
- D Anyone

---

205 RULE CHECK

Which statement best describes working within your competence?

- A I should never try anything new.
- B I only do work I know how to do well, and I get support when I take on something unfamiliar.
- C The Board will punish me if I make any mistake.
- D My licence lets me take on any work in my class.

---

206 RULE CHECK

A homeowner checks the public LBP register before hiring you. What will they see?

- A Your licence status and history, and any disciplinary action in the last 3 years
- B Your client list
- C Only your name
- D Your income and tax records

---

207 RULE CHECK

You disagree with a Building Practitioners Board disciplinary decision. Where can you appeal?

- A To the Registrar
- B To MBIE's chief executive
- C To the District Court, within 20 working days
- D To the local council

---

208 RULE CHECK

For LBP purposes, what's a Category 1 building?

- A A single residential unit with a risk matrix score under 12 on every external elevation
- B A multi-unit residential building over 10 m high
- C A building that contains non-residential parts
- D Any commercial building under 10 m

CONTRACTS & CONSUMER PROTECTION

Written contracts, disclosure, implied warranties, defect repairs and the Construction Contracts Act. Questions 209–222.

209 RULE CHECK

For residential building work, above what price must there be a written contract with the homeowner?

- A $5,000
- B $10,000
- C $30,000 including GST
- D $100,000

210 RULE CHECK

Before signing a residential contract, when must you give the client the prescribed disclosure statement and checklist?

- A When the job will cost $30,000 or more (including GST), or whenever the client asks for them
- B Only for new houses
- C Only when the client is buying the land too
- D Only when the job is under $30,000

211 RULE CHECK

When do the implied warranties for residential building work apply?

- A Only to contracts over $30,000
- B Only if they're written into the contract
- C Only to new builds
- D To all residential building work, whatever the price and whether or not there's a written contract. You can't contract out of them.

212 RULE CHECK

Which of these is NOT one of the implied warranties for residential building work?

- A The work will be done competently and in line with the plans and specifications
- B The work will be finished for the price first quoted, whatever variations the client asks for
- C The work will comply with the Building Act and Building Code
- D Materials will be suitable and, unless otherwise agreed, new

213 RULE CHECK

How long after the work do the implied warranties let a homeowner bring a claim?

- A 12 months
- B 2 years
- C 6 years
- D Up to 10 years

214 RULE CHECK

How long is the defect repair period after residential building work is completed?

- A 90 days
- B 6 months
- C 12 months
- D 24 months

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215 SITE SCENARIO

Eighteen months after completion, a client reports a defect. You think it isn't your fault. Who has to prove what?

- A The homeowner has to prove there's a defect, but the implied warranties still apply for up to 10 years.
- B Nobody. Claims end after 12 months.
- C The council decides.
- D You have to prove it isn't your fault, as in the first year.

---

216 RULE CHECK

What must you give the client when residential building work is finished, whatever the price?

- A Copies of relevant insurance policies, guarantees and warranties (with how to claim and whether they transfer), and maintenance information for the work
- B Only the code compliance certificate
- C Your record of work, and nothing else
- D Only the final invoice

---

217 RULE CHECK

What's the infringement fee for failing to give a client the disclosure statement and checklist, a compliant written contract, or the completion information?

- A $50
- B $500
- C $5,000
- D $50,000

---

218 RULE CHECK

There's no written contract for a $45,000 residential job. What happens?

- A There's no contract, so the client owes nothing.
- B The job is illegal and must stop.
- C Default clauses in the Building Act regulations apply automatically, alongside the implied warranties.
- D Only the Consumer Guarantees Act applies.

---

219 RULE CHECK

Under the Construction Contracts Act 2002, what applies if your contract doesn't set out how payments work?

- A You can only be paid at the end of the job.
- B The client sets the payment dates.
- C Pay-when-paid clauses apply.
- D The default provisions apply, with monthly progress payments.

---

220 RULE CHECK

Under the Construction Contracts Act, what must go with every payment claim you send?

- A A copy of your licence
- B The prescribed notice (Form 1) explaining how to respond and what happens if the claim isn't answered or paid
- C Photos of the work
- D A statutory declaration

---

221 RULE CHECK

You're the main contractor on a renovation. A subcontractor's tiling turns out to be defective within the first year. Who has to sort it out with the homeowner?

- A The homeowner has to chase the subcontractor directly.
- B The tile supplier
- C You, as the main contractor, because you're responsible to the homeowner for your subcontractors' work
- D The council

---

222 RULE CHECK

When pricing a residential job, what must the price for the $30,000 contract threshold include?

- A The total cost of all the building work, including subcontractors, supplies, fixtures and GST
- B Only materials
- C Everything except GST
- D Only your own labour

HEALTH & SAFETY ON SITE

PCBU and worker duties, notifiable events and work, controls, working at height and asbestos. Questions 223–237.

223 RULE CHECK

Which statement best describes the relevance of the Health and Safety at Work Act to building?

- A It prescribes how building work must be carried out.
- B It only concerns employers and site managers.
- C Construction is low risk, so the Act hardly applies.
- D It provides a framework for the health and safety of workers and workplaces.

224 RULE CHECK

Under HSWA, what does PCBU stand for?

- A Person conducting a business or undertaking
- B Public construction business union
- C Principal certified building undertaker
- D Primary contractor building unit

225 SITE SCENARIO

Your boss tells you to keep cutting near an unpropped excavation that you believe could collapse. What are your rights?

- A You must keep working or you can be dismissed.
- B You can stop, but you'll lose a day's pay.
- C You can stop or refuse the work if you believe it exposes you or others to a serious risk, and you should tell your manager as soon as possible.
- D You must finish the task first, then report it.

226 RULE CHECK

Who pays for the personal protective equipment (PPE) a worker needs?

- A The worker, as a tool of trade
- B The worker and the business split the cost
- C The business. It can't charge workers for PPE they need.
- D The client

227 RULE CHECK

Which of these is a worker's duty under HSWA?

- A To write the company's health and safety policy
- B To notify WorkSafe of every injury
- C To provide their own PPE
- D To take reasonable care for their own health and safety and that of others, and follow reasonable instructions

228 RULE CHECK

Which of these is a notifiable event that must be reported to WorkSafe?

- A A worker cutting their finger and needing a plaster
- B A death, a notifiable injury or illness, or a notifiable incident
- C A sprained wrist treated with first aid on site
- D A near miss with a dropped hammer

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229 SITE SCENARIO

A scaffold collapses and a worker is seriously injured. Once emergency services are called, what must happen to the scene?

- A Don't disturb it until a WorkSafe inspector authorises you to, except to help the injured, make the site safe or protect property.
- B Take photos, then clear it.
- C Leave it for the next day's toolbox meeting.
- D Clean it up quickly so work can carry on.

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230 RULE CHECK

When several businesses work on the same site, what does HSWA require of them?

- A The main contractor takes on everyone's duties.
- B Each business only looks after its own workers.
- C They must consult, cooperate and coordinate with each other. Duties can't be contracted out.
- D They can sign a contract moving their duties to the client.

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231 RULE CHECK

What's the right order for controlling a risk such as working at height?

- A PPE first, then training, then engineering
- B Administrative controls, then PPE, then elimination
- C Whatever is cheapest first
- D Eliminate it if you can. If not, minimise it with substitution, isolation or engineering controls, then administrative controls, and PPE last.

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232 RULE CHECK

How much notice must WorkSafe get before a trench is dug that's more than 1.5 m deep and deeper than it is wide at the top?

- A None
- B At least 24 hours
- C At least 5 working days
- D At least 20 working days

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233 SITE SCENARIO

You're re-roofing a two-storey house, where someone could fall more than 5 m. Do you need to notify WorkSafe 24 hours before starting?

- A No. Work on residential buildings up to and including two full storeys is excluded from the 5 m notification rule, but you must still manage the fall risk.
- B Only if you use scaffolding.
- C Only if the roof is steeper than 30°.
- D Yes. Any fall risk over 5 m is notifiable.

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234 RULE CHECK

Under WorkSafe's working at height guidance (August 2026), which of these is right?

- A Falls under 3 m don't need to be managed.
- B Fall risks must be managed at any height, and you should never stand on a top plate without fall protection.
- C Standing on a top plate is fine for short periods.
- D Ladders are fine for any task if you're careful.

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235 SITE SCENARIO

You're about to strip old cladding off a 1970s house. What should you consider first?

- A Nothing special, as long as you wear a dust mask.
- B Whether it contains asbestos. Pre-2000 buildings are likely to, and it must be identified and removed safely, by a licensed removalist where required.
- C Whether the council needs to inspect.
- D Only whether the cladding can be recycled.

---

236 RULE CHECK

Which welfare facilities must workers on a building site have access to?

- A None on temporary sites
- B Only a first aid kit in the ute
- C Only a portable toilet
- D Toilets and hand-washing, clean drinking water, first aid facilities, and a sheltered place for meal breaks

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237 SITE SCENARIO

The homeowner wants to wander through the site on weekends to see progress. What's your responsibility as the main contractor?

- A Make sure visitors aren't harmed by hazards in the workplace you control, for example by escorting them and briefing them on hazards.
- B Lock the site and never let them in.
- C Get them to sign a waiver so you're not responsible.
- D None. It's their property.

ANSWER KEY

QUICK ANSWER GRID

RBW · RESTRICTED BUILDING WORK & RECORDS OF WORK

1 A	2 D	3 D	4 A	5 B	6 B	7 C	8 D	9 A	10 B
11 C	12 D	13 A	14 A	15 B	16 C	17 D	18 B	19 A	20 D
21 C	22 D	23 A	24 C	25 C	26 B	27 C	28 D	29 B	30 C
31 A	32 A	33 D	34 B	35 C	36 B	37 C			

E2/AS1 · WEATHERTIGHTNESS & CLEARANCES

38 C	39 D	40 A	41 A	42 C	43 D	44 B	45 D	46 A	47 D
48 C	49 B	50 A	51 C	52 C	53 D	54 C	55 A	56 D	57 A
58 B	59 B	60 B	61 D	62 A	63 B	64 D	65 C	66 C	67 B
68 C	69 C	70 B	71 C	72 A	73 D	74 B	75 C	76 C	77 A
78 A	79 B	80 D	81 D	82 A	83 B	84 C	85 C		

NZS 3604 · B · BRACING

86 C	87 C	88 A	89 B	90 D	91 A	92 B	93 C	94 D	95 D
96 A	97 A	98 D	99 D	100 A	101 B	102 B	103 C	104 A	105 D
106 A	107 D	108 B	109 D	110 A	111 B	112 B	113 C	114 D	115 A
116 C	117 C	118 B	119 C	120 B	121 C				

NZS 3604 · FOUNDATIONS, FRAMING & TIMBER

122 A	123 C	124 D	125 A	126 C	127 C	128 C	129 B	130 B	131 B
132 D	133 D	134 C	135 A	136 D	137 A	138 C	139 C	140 B	141 C
142 C	143 C	144 A	145 D	146 C	147 B	148 C	149 D	150 B	151 A

ACT · BUILDING ACT, CODE & CONSENTS

152 A	153 D	154 A	155 C	156 C	157 A	158 B	159 D	160 B	161 B
162 C	163 D	164 A	165 C	166 D	167 A	168 B	169 C	170 A	171 B
172 D	173 B	174 C	175 B	176 A	177 C	178 D	179 D	180 D	181 A
182 C	183 B								

LBP · LICENSING, ETHICS & DISCIPLINE

184 A	185 C	186 B	187 A	188 A	189 D	190 B	191 C	192 A	193 B
194 C	195 C	196 D	197 D	198 A	199 B	200 C	201 D	202 D	203 B
204 D	205 B	206 A	207 C	208 A					

CON · CONTRACTS & CONSUMER PROTECTION

209 C	210 A	211 D	212 B	213 D	214 C	215 A	216 A	217 B	218 C
219 D	220 B	221 C	222 A						

223 D	224 A	225 C	226 C	227 D	228 B	229 A	230 C	231 D	232 B
233 A	234 B	235 B	236 D	237 A					

RBW RESTRICTED BUILDING WORK & RECORDS OF WORK

1 **A.** Give a record of work for the RBW you carried out or supervised up to the day you left, to the owner and the council.

A record of work is due when your part of the restricted building work is finished, and leaving the job early (or being dismissed, or the company being liquidated) counts as finishing. Give it to the homeowner and the territorial authority, listing the work you completed and the work still to be done. Another LBP can't take responsibility for your work, and you can't hold the record back over a payment dispute.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Say who gets it (owner and council), when it's due (when your RBW ends, not when the job ends), and that it isn't a bargaining chip.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.11 · Building Act 2004 s88

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2 **D.** No. RBW covers houses and purely residential small-to-medium apartment buildings, and this building is mixed-use.

RBW only applies to houses and small-to-medium apartment buildings (two or more residential units, no commercial units, under 10 m high). A building with a café or shops is mixed-use, so the work isn't RBW. It still has to follow the consent and the Building Code, and as an LBP you're accountable to the Board for all building work you carry out or supervise, RBW or not.

Ref: LBP Handbook pp.8–9 · Building (Definition of Restricted Building Work) Order 2011

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3 **D.** The other LBP. An LBP can't supervise another LBP in the same licence class, so each LBP who does RBW provides their own record of work.

Each LBP is personally accountable to the Building Practitioners Board, and that accountability can't be passed to a supervisor. Two LBPs in the same class can help or mentor each other, but each provides a record of work for the RBW they did. Wall cladding is part of the external moisture-management system, so it is RBW. Records of work come from individual LBPs, not companies.

Ref: LBP Handbook pp.10–11 · Codewords 132

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4 **A.** Demolishing an old house to clear the site

RBW is the construction or alteration (or design) of the primary structure or external moisture-management system of a home. Demolition and removal aren't construction or alteration, so they aren't RBW. The other three all affect primary structure or weathertightness.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.8 (RBW flowchart)

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5 **B.** It isn't exempt. Repairing work that failed its durability requirements (like a leak) or substantially replacing structural framing needs a building consent, so it's RBW.

Schedule 1's repair and maintenance exemption excludes repairing or replacing components that failed to meet the Building Code's durability requirements (for example, because of an external moisture failure) and complete or substantial replacement of structural components. So this work needs a consent, and because it involves primary structure and the external moisture-management system of a house, it's RBW.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Leaky-building repairs are a classic assessor scenario. Explain why the exemption doesn't apply, not just that it doesn't.

Ref: Building Act 2004 Schedule 1, exemption 1 · building.govt.nz exempt work guidance

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6 **B.** No. Work that doesn't need a building consent isn't RBW (consent-exempt granny flats aside), though it must still meet the Building Code.

For ordinary building work, RBW only covers work that needs a building consent, so Schedule 1 exempt work isn't RBW. It still has to comply with the Building Code (including F4 barriers where there's a 1 m fall), and if you're an LBP you're still accountable for doing it competently. The exception is consent-exempt granny flats, which do include RBW.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.8 · Building Act 2004 s17 and Schedule 1

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7 **C.** No. The exemption only covers RBW the owner does personally or with unpaid friends and family. Paid workers doing RBW must be LBPs or supervised by one.

Under section 90B, an owner-builder can carry out RBW on their own home themselves or with help from unpaid friends or family. Anyone paid to do RBW must be an appropriately licensed LBP or be supervised by one, and any paid LBPs on the job must provide records of work.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s90B · Codewords (owner-builders)

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8 **D.** The owner holds a building trade qualification

An owner-builder must be a person who lives or intends to live in the home, does the RBW personally or with unpaid friends and family, hasn't used the exemption on a different home in the previous 3 years, and gives the BCA a statutory declaration. No trade qualification is needed.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s90B

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9 **A.** No. The owner-builder exemption isn't available for Schedule 1A granny flats.

Granny flats built without consent under Schedule 1A must be designed and built (or supervised) by LBPs, and section 90D(1A) rules out the owner-builder exemption for them. The council doesn't inspect these builds, so the LBP records are the main record of who did the work.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s90D(1A) and Schedule 1A

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10 **B.** The owner and the territorial authority (the council)

Section 88 says each LBP who carries out or supervises RBW under a consent must give a record of work to the owner and the territorial authority. For a consent-exempt granny flat it goes to the owner and the council that issued the PIM.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s88(1), (1A) and (2)

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11 **C.** On completion of the RBW you carried out or supervised, even if the rest of the job is still going

Section 88 says you provide it on completion of your restricted building work, not the whole project. If you're engaged for part of a job, it's due when your part is done. The Board expects it promptly, within weeks rather than months.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s88 · LBP Handbook p.11

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12 **D.** No. A record of work can't be withheld over payment or any other dispute. Recover the money through your contract or the Construction Contracts Act.

The record of work is a statutory obligation, not a contract term, and the Board treats withholding it for non-payment as a failure to provide it without good reason. That's a disciplinary offence. Chase payment separately, for example under the Construction Contracts Act.

Ref: Building Act 2004 ss88 and 317(1)(da) · Codewords 119

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13 **A.** No. You're responsible for making sure your record of work reaches the owner and the council.

The duty sits with each LBP personally. Giving it to someone else who doesn't pass it on still leaves you in breach. Send it to the owner and the council yourself, and keep proof that you did.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s88 · Codewords 119

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14 **A.** Records which restricted building work you carried out or supervised. It doesn't, of itself, create any liability.

A record of work (prescribed form 6A) is a statement of what RBW you did or supervised, so the owner and council know who was responsible. Section 88(4) says it doesn't, of itself, create liability. It isn't a guarantee or a certificate of compliance.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s88(4) · LBP Handbook p.11

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15 **B.** You do, as the LBP who supervised the RBW

Section 88 applies to LBPs who carry out or supervise RBW. The apprentice isn't licensed, so the supervising LBP records the RBW they supervised and is accountable for it being done competently and to the consent.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s88 · LBP Handbook p.9

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16 **C.** It's a ground for discipline by the Building Practitioners Board, and recent penalties include fines of $1,000 to $1,500 plus costs.

Failing without good reason to provide a record of work is a specific ground for discipline under section 317(1)(da)(ii). The Board can censure, fine and order costs, and it regularly hears these complaints.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s317(1)(da) · lbp.govt.nz (recent Board decisions, 2026)

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17 **D.** A certificate of work comes from the design LBP with the consent application; a record of work comes from each LBP who carries out or supervises RBW.

Design LBPs complete a certificate of work (Form 2A) setting out the RBW design work and who did it, and it's lodged with the consent application. LBPs who build or supervise RBW give records of work (Form 6A) when their RBW is complete.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.11 · Building Act 2004 s88 and s317(1)(da)

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18 **B.** Providing control or direction and oversight of the work, enough to ensure it's done competently and complies with the building consent (if any)

Section 7 defines supervise as providing control or direction and oversight to an extent sufficient to ensure the work is performed competently and complies with the building consent (if any). You don't need to be there all the time, but you're responsible for the work's quality and compliance.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE The words (if any) were added in October 2025, alongside the changes that brought consent-exempt granny flats into the RBW regime.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s7

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19 **A.** Direct: be there, guiding and checking the work as it's done

The supervision risk matrix weighs the skill of the person against the complexity of the work. A low-skilled worker on complex, high-risk work needs direct supervision. Remote supervision only suits highly skilled people doing simple work.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.9 (supervision risk matrix) · LBP supervision practice note

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20 **D.** You don't have to be on site all the time, but you're responsible for the quality and compliance of the work you supervise.

Only an LBP licensed in the right class can supervise RBW. The amount of on-site presence depends on the worker's skill and the complexity of the work, but the supervising LBP is accountable for it either way. The Board has disciplined LBPs whose supervision wasn't enough.

Ref: LBP Handbook pp.9–10

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21 **C.** Anyone, although an LBP who does or supervises it is still accountable for it

Non-RBW building work can be supervised by anyone. But if you're an LBP, the Board can discipline you over any building work you carry out or supervise (for example for negligence or not following the consent), not only RBW.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.9

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22 **D.** Laying a clay brick veneer

Carpentry LBPs can do framing, cladding, joinery installation and other carpentry RBW, and can also do foundations and lightweight profiled metal roofing without holding those licences. Brick veneer is Brick and Blocklaying licence work. Solid plaster and proprietary plaster claddings need an External Plastering licence, and other roof types such as tiles and membranes need a Roofing licence.

Ref: lbp.govt.nz (Carpentry factsheet and licensing classes)

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23 **A.** No. The Site licence covers coordinating and overseeing building work, not carrying out or supervising RBW, so Site LBPs don't issue records of work.

Site LBPs coordinate and oversee construction and manage the building process, but they're not licensed to carry out or supervise RBW. That needs a trade licence such as Carpentry.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.7

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24 **C.** $50,000

Under section 85, carrying out or supervising RBW without the right licence is an offence with a fine of up to $50,000 (raised from $20,000 in 2021). The council can also issue an instant infringement fine of $750, and MBIE can prosecute.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s85 · lbp.govt.nz (offences and penalties)

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25 **C.** $50,000

Section 86 makes it an offence to engage someone you know isn't appropriately licensed to carry out or supervise RBW: up to $50,000 for an individual and $150,000 for a company.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s86

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26 **B.** Yes. It's a small-to-medium apartment building: two or more residential units, no commercial units, under 10 m high.

RBW covers houses (free-standing single residential units) and small-to-medium apartment buildings, meaning buildings with two or more residential units, no commercial units, and under 10 m high. At 10 m or more, the same work is no longer RBW.

Ref: Building (Definition of Restricted Building Work) Order 2011 · LBP Handbook p.8

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27 **C.** No. RBW covers houses and small-to-medium apartment buildings, not detached garages, sheds and other outbuildings.

Detached outbuildings like garages and sheds aren't houses, so their construction isn't RBW. A garage attached to the house is part of the house, so its structure and weathertightness are RBW.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.8 · Codewords 74

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28 **D.** Yes. Bracing is part of the primary structure, so the bracing element is RBW and needs an LBP to carry it out or supervise it.

Primary structure includes the elements that resist vertical and horizontal loads, including bracing. A plasterboard bracing element is part of that system, so lining it as specified is RBW, and you'll need to provide a record of work.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.10 (supervision examples) · RBW Order 2011

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29 **B.** No. It isn't primary structure or the external moisture-management system.

RBW only covers the primary structure and external moisture-management system (and fire safety design for apartments). A non-structural internal partition is neither. It still has to match the consent and the Building Code, and you're still accountable as an LBP.

Ref: RBW Order 2011 · LBP Handbook pp.8–9

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30 **C.** It can be exempt under Schedule 1 (window and door replacement in an existing dwelling of two storeys or less), so it isn't RBW. It must still meet the Building Code.

Schedule 1 lets windows and exterior doors in existing dwellings of up to two storeys be replaced without a consent. The exemption doesn't apply if the window is being replaced because it failed its durability requirements (for example a leak), or if the work affects a specified system. Then a consent is needed and the work is RBW.

Ref: Building Act 2004 Schedule 1 (exemption 8)

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31 **A.** The first LBP gives a record of work for their RBW so far, and the owner tells the BCA about the new LBP who will carry out or supervise the RBW.

Each LBP records only their own RBW, and leaving the job counts as completing your part. The owner must tell the BCA who is carrying out or supervising the RBW, and must update the BCA when that changes.

Ref: LBP Handbook pp.11, 14 and 18

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32 **A.** Yes. LBPs are accountable to the Board for all building work they carry out or supervise, including work that isn't RBW.

The disciplinary grounds, such as negligence, incompetence and not following the building consent, apply to any building work an LBP carries out or supervises. Your licence is on the line whatever the job.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.9 · Building Act 2004 s317

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33 **D.** Yes. Since 15 January 2026, RBW includes consent-exempt granny flats, so LBPs must carry out or supervise it and provide records of work.

The 2025 amendment brought Schedule 1A granny flats into the RBW regime even though they don't need a consent. LBPs carry out or supervise the RBW, the designer provides a certificate of work, and records of work go to the owner and the council that issued the PIM.

Ref: Building Act 2004 ss88(1A) and 401B · Schedule 1A

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34 **B.** 1 March 2012

The RBW requirements began on 1 March 2012. The LBP scheme itself started in November 2007, the consumer protection rules (written contracts and checklists) began on 1 January 2015, and the LBP Code of Ethics became enforceable on 25 October 2022.

Ref: Building (Definition of Restricted Building Work) Order 2011 · LBP Handbook p.5

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35 **C.** Subfloor framing and bracing

Primary structure means the building elements that help it withstand vertical or horizontal loads, such as foundations, subfloor framing, walls, bracing, beams, columns and the roof structure. Fit-out items aren't primary structure.

Ref: Building (Definition of Restricted Building Work) Order 2011

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36 **B.** The wall cladding, flashings, wall underlay and window installation

The external moisture-management system is everything that keeps outside moisture out: roof and wall cladding, flashings, underlays, cavities, and window and door installation. Bathroom waterproofing deals with internal moisture (clause E3), so it isn't part of it.

Ref: Building (Definition of Restricted Building Work) Order 2011 · LBP Handbook p.8

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37 **C.** Only take it on if you can do it competently, for example with the engineer's input and experienced support, and be upfront about your experience.

Your licence class sets what you're allowed to do, but you must only carry out or supervise work within your competence (s314B). For unfamiliar work, get the right support and mentoring, and never misrepresent your experience. Going outside your competence is a ground for discipline.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s314B · LBP Handbook p.11

E2/AS1 WEATHERTIGHTNESS & CLEARANCES

38 **C.** 100 mm

The bottom of the cladding must finish at least 100 mm above a paved surface, or 175 mm above unpaved ground. At 60 mm, splash and ponding water can get up behind the cladding. The path needs lowering or cutting back before the final inspection.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Learn the pair: 100 mm to paved, 175 mm to unpaved. Landscaping done after you leave site is a common way these get lost, so point it out to the owner.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 9.1.2.1 and para 9.1.2.6

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39 **D.** 225 mm

The slab must sit at least 225 mm above unpaved ground, or 150 mm above paved ground. Set slab levels so these heights still work once the final landscaping goes in.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE For masonry veneer the slab heights in the same table are 100 mm (paved) and 150 mm (unpaved).

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 9.1.2.1 and para 9.1.2.4

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40 **A.** Category 2

Category 1 is a single residential unit with a risk matrix score under 12 on every elevation. A score of 12 or more on any one elevation makes it Category 2. Category 3 covers multi-unit buildings over 10 m high and buildings with non-residential parts.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.6 · E2/AS1 Table 3.1.3.1

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41 **A.** Distance from the coast

The six risk factors are wind zone, number of storeys, roof/wall intersection design, eaves width, envelope complexity and deck design. Distance from the coast matters for the durability of fixings and flashings (exposure zones), not for the risk score.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Be able to list all six from memory. Assessors often ask you to talk through a risk matrix on one of your own jobs.

Ref: E2/AS1 Figure 3.1.1.1 and Table 3.1.2.1

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42 **C.** 11

Wind zone Very High = 2. Two storeys = 2. Roof/wall fully protected = 0. Eaves of 450 mm on a two-storey building = 5 (0–450 mm is very high risk at two storeys). Simple shape, single cladding = 0. Slat deck attached at first floor = 2. Total 2 + 2 + 0 + 5 + 0 + 2 = 11.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Eaves width scores depend on the number of storeys. 450 mm eaves score 2 on a single storey but 5 on two storeys.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 3.1.2.1 and Table 3.1.3.1

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43 **D.** Fix them over a nominal 20 mm drained cavity.

Fibre cement weatherboards can only be direct fixed for scores of 0 to 6. From 7 to 20 they must go over a nominal 20 mm drained cavity. Over 20, E2/AS1 no longer applies: redesign to lower the score or use specific design.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 3.1.3.2

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44 **B.** 12

All timber weatherboard types can be direct fixed for scores of 0 to 6, and bevel-back weatherboards (and vertical board and batten) can still be direct fixed from 7 to 12. From 13 to 20, bevel-back weatherboards need a drained cavity.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Rusticated weatherboards are different: they need a cavity from a score of 7.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 3.1.3.2

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45 **D.** Redesign to bring the score down, or treat that face as specific design outside E2/AS1.

A score over 20 is outside E2/AS1. Either change the design (for example wider eaves or a simpler deck) to lower the score, or go down a specific-design path. With specific design the council may ask for more detail, more inspections or a third-party review.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 3.1.3.2 and note 8

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46 **A.** Horizontally from the outside face of the wall cladding to the outer edge of the overhang, including fascia and gutter.

Eaves width is measured horizontally from the external face of the wall cladding to the outer edge of the overhang, and fascias and external gutters count. Balustrades and parapets count as 0 mm eaves.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 3.1.2.1 notes 1 and 2

---

47 **D.** 0 mm

Parapets and balustrades count as 0 mm eaves, so that face scores the maximum for eaves width. A parapet also makes the roof/wall intersection fully exposed (3). Parapets push risk scores up quickly.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 3.1.2.1 note 2

---

48 **C.** 4 (high)

An enclosed deck exposed in plan or cantilevered at first-floor level is high risk (4). At second floor or above it's very high (6). A timber slat deck at ground level scores 0, and a deck fully covered by roof or a slat deck at first or second floor scores 2.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 3.1.2.1

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49 **B.** Nominal 20 mm (18–25 mm thick) and at least 45 mm wide

Cavity battens are nominal 20 mm, between 18 and 25 mm thick, at least 45 mm wide, and fixed through the wall underlay into the framing by the cladding fixings. Timber battens must meet B2/AS1 for treatment.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.7.8

---

50 **A.** Drained and open to the outside at the bottom (with vermin-proofing), but not vented at the top.

Drained cavities must be open at the bottom so water can drain out, with vermin-proofing across the opening. Apart from masonry veneer, the cavity is not vented at the top. Air movement between the cavity and the framing, roof space and subfloor also has to be restricted.

Ref: E2/AS1 paras 9.1.7.2 and 9.1.7.4

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51 **C.** 3–5 mm holes or slots, giving at least 1000 mm² of opening per metre of wall

Vermin-proofing needs holes or slots between 3 and 5 mm, adding up to 1000 mm² of opening per lineal metre of wall, so the cavity can still drain and breathe. It goes at the base of the cavity and above window and door heads.

Ref: E2/AS1 paras 9.1.7.5 and 9.1.7.7

---

52 **C.** 15 mm

The cladding needs a drip edge of at least 15 mm past the vermin-proofing above window and door head flashings, and at least 10 mm at the base of walls.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.7.7(c)

---

53 **D.** Run it horizontally, upper sheets over lower, with 75 mm horizontal laps and 150 mm laps over studs at vertical joins.

Flexible wall underlay runs horizontally with upper sheets lapped over lower ones so water sheds outwards. Laps are at least 75 mm at horizontal joints and 150 mm over studs at vertical joints. It extends 35 mm below the bottom plate or bearer.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Supervising RBW means checking details like this before the cladding hides them.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.6.1

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54 **C.** 35 mm

The wall underlay must extend 35 mm below the bottom plate or bearer, so water running down it drips clear of the framing.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.6.1(e)

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55 **A.** A rigid underlay, such as 7 mm H3 plywood or 6 mm fibre cement, with a drained cavity.

In Extra High wind zones every cladding goes over a drained cavity and a rigid underlay (at least 7 mm H3 plywood or 6 mm fibre cement, sheet edges on solid framing, over-fixed with flexible underlay, cavity battens at 600 mm maximum centres). Flashing upstands also need hooks or hems plus an extra 25 mm.

Ref: E2/AS1 paras 9.1.1.4, 9.1.6.2 and 9.1.6.4

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56 **D.** Self-expanding polyurethane foam or sealant, installed over a closed-cell PEF backing rod

Every window, door and penetration needs a flexible air seal between the reveal or frame and the wrapped opening. E2/AS1 accepts self-expanding polyurethane foam or a suitable sealant, both installed over a closed-cell polyethylene foam (PEF) backing rod.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.5.1

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57 **A.** To stop the foam expanding out to the exterior and forming a moisture bridge to the inside

Without a backing rod, expanding foam can push right through to the outside of the wall and form a bridge that carries water inwards. The air seal's job is to stop wind-driven air (and the water it carries) getting through the reveal.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.5.1 comment

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58 **B.** 8 mm

The facing flange must overlap the surrounding cladding or back flashings by at least 8 mm at the sill and 10 mm at the jambs and head.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.9.3 and Table 4.5.1.1

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59 **B.** 35 mm

Head flashings lap at least 35 mm under the cladding above, rising to 60 mm in Extra High wind zones. The head flashing slopes at 15°, has a 40 mm total upstand, and keeps a 5 mm (maximum 10 mm) anti-capillary gap to the cladding.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 4.5.1.1 (Heads)

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60 **B.** 5 mm (10 mm maximum), as an anti-capillary gap

A 5 mm gap, and no more than 10 mm, stops water being drawn up between the cladding and the flashing by capillary action. Sealing the cladding down onto the flashing traps water instead.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 4.5.1.1 (Heads)

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61 **D.** No. E2/AS1 window details only cover horizontal heads, so a sloped head needs specific design.

Within E2/AS1, aluminium windows and doors must have horizontal heads only. Sloped heads need specifically designed kick-out flashings at the bottom of the head flashing. E2/AS1 also limits frame size: 5000 × 5000 mm and 13.5 m² for sills above floor level, or 6000 mm wide and 16 m² for sills at floor level.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.9.1

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62 **A.** The sill flashing slopes back towards the building.

Sill flashings must extend past the condensation channel and must never slope backwards towards the building, because a back slope runs water into the wall. E2/AS1 Table 4.5.1.1 shows the sill flashing for direct-fixed windows as flat.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 4.5.1.1 note 6

---

63 **B.** Two storeys or 7 m, whichever is less

A continuous drained cavity is limited to the lesser of two storeys or 7 m. Beyond that, an inter-storey flashing bridges the cavity and drains it to the outside, so the cavity doesn't carry too much water.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.8.4

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64 **D.** Overlapping the slab by 50 mm, held off the slab face by at least 6 mm

The base of the cladding overlaps the slab by 50 mm. For direct-fixed claddings it's also held off the slab face by at least 6 mm so water can't wick up by capillary action. It must still finish 100 mm above paving or 175 mm above unpaved ground.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.2.6

---

65 **C.** 50 mm

The cladding must overlap the timber floor structure by at least 50 mm. It must also keep 100 mm clearance to paving and 175 mm to unpaved ground, and there must be no direct connection between the subfloor space and a drained cavity.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.2.8 and Table 9.1.2.1 note 2

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66 **C.** 35 mm

Wall cladding must finish at least 35 mm above roof claddings and membrane decks, measured to the top of the apron flashing. The gap keeps the cladding's bottom edge dry and lets it be cleaned and painted.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Keeping this 35 mm clearance is listed as ongoing maintenance in E2/AS1, so mention it in the owner's maintenance information.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.2.2 and Table 4.5.1.1

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67 **B.** 110 mm

Roof-to-wall metal flashings need a total upstand of 110 mm, with a 75 mm lap under the cladding above and 35 mm clearance below the cladding. In Extra High wind zones the upstand rises to 125 mm and the lap to 90 mm.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 4.5.1.1 (Roof or deck to wall)

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68 **C.** 115 mm

Membrane roofs and decks need at least 115 mm lap under the cladding above, with the cladding still 35 mm clear of the membrane surface.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 4.5.1.1 (Membrane roofs and decks)

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69 **C.** 100 mm

Enclosed decks need at least 100 mm between the opening threshold and the finished deck surface. Level thresholds onto enclosed decks need the special removable-surface details in Part 7.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 7.2.3.1

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70 **B.** 12 mm

Leave at least a 12 mm gap between the external wall and the adjacent decking slat so water can drain and debris doesn't pack against the cladding.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 7.2.2.2

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71 **C.** 50 mm

For cantilevered slatted decks, the deck surface must be at least 50 mm below the threshold. A non-cantilevered slatted deck built to the E2/AS1 junction detail can be level with the threshold. Enclosed decks need 100 mm.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 7.2.2.1

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72 **A.** A 35 m² deck with a 1:40 fall, no steps, and no downpipes discharging onto it

Membrane decks under E2/AS1 must be butyl or EPDM over plywood, with a fall of at least 1.5° (1:40), a maximum area of 40 m², no steps in level except into gutters, no integral roof gardens and no downpipes discharging directly onto the deck.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 8.5.1.2

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73 **D.** 1:30 (2°)

Membrane roofs need at least 2° (1:30). Membrane decks need at least 1.5° (1:40), and internal gutters at least 1:100 with no cross seams.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 8.5.1.2

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74 **B.** Corrugate needs at least 8°, so use a trough profile or a trapezoidal profile with crests 27 mm or higher (3° minimum).

For metal roofs up to 18 m long without end laps, corrugated needs at least 8° (1:7). Trough profiles can go to 3°, and trapezoidal to 3° if the crest is 27 mm or higher (4° if lower). Check the manufacturer's requirements too, as they may be stricter.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 8.4.4.1

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75 **C.** 20%

Framing must be at 20% or less in insulated buildings (24% in non-insulated), or lower if NZS 3602 or the lining manufacturer says so. Timber weatherboards and joinery must be at 20% or less when painted, and concrete slabs must read below 75% relative humidity before fixed floor coverings go down.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Know how you'd check it on site: a calibrated resistance meter, probes at least a third of the way into the timber, more than 200 mm from board ends.

Ref: E2/AS1 paras 10.1.2.1 and 10.2.1.1

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76 **C.** 50 mm minimum total level change between the garage floor and the exterior paving

Garage openings need at least a 50 mm total level change between inside and outside paving, plus drainage away from the threshold. Ways to get it include a 50 mm drop in ground level, a raised threshold or concrete nibs. At the door opening, the bottom of the cladding must also be at least 25 mm above the driveway, and unlined external garage walls need a rigid underlay.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.1.6

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77 **A.** 480 mm

Dwangs are at 1350 mm maximum centres generally, but 480 mm maximum behind direct-fixed vertical weatherboards and vertical corrugated or symmetrical trapezoidal metal, because those claddings fix into horizontal framing.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.1.5

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78 **A.** Both hooks or hems and an extra 25 mm of upstand

In Low to Very High wind zones you can either fold hooks or hems on upstands or leave them off and add 25 mm to the upstand. In Extra High wind zones you need both. Exposed bottom edges of flashings get a kick-out or bird's beak.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 4.4.3.4 and Table 4.5.1.1 note 1

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79 **B.** No. E2/AS1 is limited to 10 m, measured from the lowest adjacent ground level to the highest point of the roof.

E2/AS1 covers timber-framed buildings within NZS 3604, up to 3 storeys and no more than 10 m from the lowest ground level next to the building to the highest point of the roof (chimneys and aerials excluded). Above that, weathertightness needs an alternative solution or specific design.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 1.1.1.1

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80 **D.** The 4th edition. The 3rd edition could only be used for applications lodged before 1 August 2026.

E2/AS1 4th edition took effect on 28 July 2025. The 3rd edition could still be used for applications submitted before 1 August 2026, so anything lodged now uses the 4th edition (or another compliance path).

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Assessors expect you to know which documents are current. Codewords and LBP updates flag changes like this.

Ref: E2/AS1 4th edition, Preface (document status)

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81 **D.** A gap of at least 10 mm between the bottom of the battens and the flashing, so air can move between cavities

Where a penetration is wider than the batten spacing, leave at least a 10 mm gap between the bottom of each vertical cavity batten and the flashing below. That lets air and water move between neighbouring cavity spaces.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.8.2

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82 **A.** An intermediate restraint, such as polypropylene tape or galvanised wire at 300 mm centres, to stop the wrap and insulation bulging into the cavity

Where studs are more than 450 mm apart and only flexible wrap is used, the wrap and insulation must be restrained from bulging into the cavity. Accepted options are 75 mm galvanised mesh, polypropylene tape or galvanised wire at 300 mm centres drawn taut, or extra cavity battens at 300 mm maximum centres.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 9.1.7.10

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83 **B.** The interior linings, with all joints stopped

Up to Very High wind zones, the barrier to airflow is the interior lining with all joints stopped. In Extra High zones a rigid underlay does this job. Unlined walls, such as attic gable ends, need an air barrier fixed to the framing before the cladding or battens.

Ref: E2/AS1 paras 9.1.3.1 and 9.1.3.2

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84 **C.** 50 years

Flashings that are completely hidden behind claddings like masonry veneer, or otherwise inaccessible, need 50-year durability. Exposed, partly exposed or accessible flashings need 15 years. Two-part flashings let you replace the exposed part without removing cladding.

Ref: E2/AS1 para 4.2.1.1 comment · Building Code clause B2

85 **C.** 40 mm

Masonry veneer always goes over a drained cavity, at least 40 mm for traditional veneer to SNZ HB 4236. Other claddings that need a cavity use the nominal 20 mm cavity.

Ref: E2/AS1 Table 3.1.3.2 note 3

NZS 3604 · B BRACING

86 **C.** 20

NZS 3604 measures bracing in bracing units, where 1 BU = 0.05 kN (50 N). So 1 kN = 20 BUs, and 100 BUs is about 5 kN. Demand and bracing element ratings are both in BUs, so you can compare them directly.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5 · GIB Bracing Supplement

87 **C.** 380 BUs

Work out wind and earthquake demand in each direction, along and across. The larger of the two governs that direction, so the walls along the building need at least 380 BUs. Check each direction separately: wind can govern one way and earthquake the other.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5

88 **A.** The 6.8 m gap is more than the 6 m maximum, so another bracing line is needed between 4.2 m and 11.0 m.

NZS 3604 limits the spacing between parallel wall bracing lines to 6 m (clause 5.4.6). The gap from 4.2 m to 11.0 m is 6.8 m, so add a line in between, for example an internal wall near 7.6 m, with enough bracing to meet that line's minimum.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE The 6 m limit can be extended with dragon ties (rooms up to 7.5 m) or a ceiling diaphragm (up to 12 m), but only when those are designed and built to NZS 3604.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 5.4.6

89 **B.** 7.5 m

The standard maximum spacing between bracing lines is 6 m. Dragon ties built to NZS 3604 allow rooms up to 7.5 m × 7.5 m, so lines up to 7.5 m apart. A ceiling diaphragm allows up to 12 m.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5 · GIB EzyBrace Systems (bracing distribution)

90 **D.** 12 m

A ceiling diaphragm transfers load to the bracing lines around it, so those lines can be up to 12 m apart. The diaphragm must be no more than 12 m long, no longer than twice its width, and have bracing lines on all four sides.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 5.6 and 13.5 · GIB EzyBrace Systems (ceiling diaphragms)

91 **A.** The greatest of 100 BUs, 15 BUs per metre of external wall, and 50% of the total demand divided by the number of lines in that direction

Every bracing line needs at least the greater of 100 BUs or 50% of the total demand divided by the number of lines in that direction. Lines along external walls also need at least 15 BUs per metre of that wall. Use whichever of these is largest.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Internal lines don't have the 15 BU/m rule, just 100 BUs or the 50% rule.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5 · GIB EzyBrace Systems p.8

92 **B.** 100 BUs

The 50% rule gives 50% × 600 ÷ 4 = 75 BUs, but every line needs at least 100 BUs. The greater of the two is 100 BUs. Internal lines don't get the 15 BU per metre external wall rule.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5

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93 **C.** 180 BUs

Check all three minimums. 100 BUs. 15 BUs × 12 m of external wall = 180 BUs. 50% × 1000 ÷ 3 = 167 BUs. The greatest is 180 BUs.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5

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94 **D.** Yes. Parallel elements up to 2 m apart can be counted on one line.

Parallel walls less than 1 m apart count as one line. Between 1 m and 2 m apart they can be treated as one line or two. More than 2 m apart, they're separate lines.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5 · GIB EzyBrace Systems (bracing distribution)

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95 **D.** No, unless a continuous member, such as a ribbon plate fixed across the studs above the nogs or a GIBFix Angle, is installed at the ceiling line.

Bracing elements must be fixed from top plate to bottom plate. Fixing to a row of nogs is only acceptable with a continuous member at the ceiling line, such as an ex 90 × 45 ribbon plate fixed across the studs or a GIBFix Angle, so the load can get into the structure.

Ref: GIB EzyBrace Systems (parapets and gable end walls)

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96 **A.** Specific panel hold-down fixings are needed at each end of the element

H means the element needs specific panel hold-down fixings at each end. N means no specific hold-downs (normal bottom plate fixings to NZS 3604 apply). NOM means the nominal plasterboard fixing pattern. BL is GIB Braceline, GS is GIB Standard, P is plywood, and 1 or 2 is lining on one or both sides.

Ref: GIB EzyBrace Systems (specification numbering)

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97 **A.** GIB Standard plasterboard on one side, with no specific hold-down fixings

GS is GIB Standard plasterboard, 1 means lined on one side, and N means no specific panel hold-downs are needed. GS1-N is the go-to element for available wall lengths. You change to BL1-H if you need a higher rating.

Ref: GIB EzyBrace Systems p.8

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98 **D.** A hold-down with at least 15 kN characteristic uplift capacity and a 50 × 50 × 3 mm washer, within 80 mm of the end of the element (or a GIB HandiBrac)

H-type elements need a hold-down at each end. On concrete that's a mechanical fastening with at least 15 kN characteristic uplift capacity and a 50 × 50 × 3 mm square washer, within 80 mm of the end of the element. The GIB HandiBrac with its screw bolt is an approved alternative to a strap.

Ref: GIB EzyBrace Systems (hold-down fastener requirements)

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99 **D.** A 12 × 150 mm galvanised coach screw with a 50 × 50 × 3 mm washer, within 80 mm of the end, into a solid joist or block

On timber floors the hold-down goes into a solid joist or full-depth block: a 12 × 150 mm galvanised coach screw with a 50 × 50 × 3 mm square washer within 80 mm of each end of the element (or the GIB HandiBrac with its supplied screw bolt).

Ref: GIB EzyBrace Systems (hold-down fastener requirements)

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100 **A.** Pairs of 100 × 3.75 mm hand-driven nails, or three 90 × 3.15 mm power-driven nails, at 600 mm centres

N-type elements rely on the standard NZS 3604 bottom plate fixings. On timber floors that's pairs of 100 × 3.75 mm hand-driven nails or three 90 × 3.15 mm power-driven nails at 600 mm centres.

Ref: GIB EzyBrace Systems (bottom plate fixings) · NZS 3604:2011

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101 **B.** Yes. Uneven bracing lets the building twist (torsion) in an earthquake, so spread bracing evenly and as close as practical to external corners.

The NZS 3604 rules are minimums. The designer still has to check that bracing is evenly distributed. Bracing bunched at one end lets the building rotate under load, which can cause damage in an earthquake.

Ref: GIB EzyBrace Systems (bracing distribution)

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102 **B.** 10%

The default is an earthquake with a 10% chance of being exceeded in the assumed 50-year design life, which is a return period of about 500 years. Some commercial and public buildings are designed for rarer, stronger events.

Ref: GIB EzyBrace Systems (bracing demand)

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103 **C.** 44 m/s

The NZS 3604 wind zones are Low 32 m/s, Medium 37 m/s, High 44 m/s, Very High 50 m/s and Extra High 55 m/s. Sites above 55 m/s are outside NZS 3604 and need specific engineering design.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Table 5.1

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104 **A.** The site is beyond Extra High and outside NZS 3604, so it needs specific engineering design.

Extra High (55 m/s) is the top of NZS 3604's range. Anything above that is outside the standard's scope and needs specific engineering design (SED), usually by a structural engineer.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Table 5.1

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105 **D.** Soil class

Wind zone comes from wind region and lee zones, ground roughness, site exposure and topographic class (T1 to T4). Soil class is used for earthquake demand, not wind.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5 · BRANZ Level (site analysis: wind)

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106 **A.** Zone 1

Earthquake zones run from 1 (lowest) to 4 (highest). B1/AS1 modifies the zone map so that all of Christchurch City, and any Zone 1 land in Selwyn and Waimakariri districts, is treated as Zone 2.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Figure 5.4 · B1/AS1 2nd edition para 2.3.4.1

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107 **D.** Class E (deep or soft soil)

Earthquake demand is multiplied by a factor for earthquake zone and soil class. If the soil class isn't known, use class E, which is the most onerous.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5

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108 **B.** The type of plasterboard used in the bracing elements

Demand is what the building needs to resist, and it depends on location (wind and earthquake zones, soil), size and shape, and weight (heavy or light roof and cladding). The plasterboard and bracing elements are on the resistance side of the calculation.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5

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109 **D.** Earthquake demand, because the building is heavier

Earthquake loads come from the building's mass, so a heavier roof increases earthquake demand. Wind demand depends mainly on the building's size, shape, height and exposure.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5

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110 **A.** The ground floor walls resist the loads from the upper storey and roof as well as their own.

Lateral loads build up down the building. The ground floor walls carry the wind and earthquake loads from everything above them, so ground-floor demand is higher than upper-floor demand.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5

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111 **B.** Ordinary piles

Ordinary piles carry vertical load only. Subfloor bracing comes from anchor piles, braced pile systems, cantilever (driven) piles, or bracing walls and foundation walls.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 6 · BRANZ Bulletin 617

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112 **B.** 5 m

Subfloor bracing lines are limited to 5 m apart, closer than the 6 m allowed for wall bracing lines. Subfloor demand is worked out separately from wall bracing, and anchor piles, braced piles or foundation walls provide the resistance.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5 · BRANZ Bulletin 617

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113 **C.** 160 / 120 BUs

Anchor piles and braced pile systems are each rated 160 BUs for wind and 120 BUs for earthquake. A cantilever pile is rated 70 BUs for wind and 30 BUs for earthquake.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Table 5.11

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114 **D.** No. Openings over 90 × 90 mm (or 100 mm round) go outside the bracing element, or the bracing moves to the other side of the wall.

GIB allows small openings in bracing elements, like power outlets, up to 90 × 90 mm or 100 mm diameter. They must be at least 90 mm from the element's edge and 250 mm from the top and bottom, with limits on how many per stud bay. Larger openings, like switchboards and recessed cabinets, go outside the element.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Coordinate service locations with other trades before lining. Integration with other trades is one of the Carpentry competencies.

Ref: GIB EzyBrace Systems (openings in bracing elements)

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115 **A.** Get the designer to recheck the bracing, and get the change approved by the BCA (as a minor variation or amendment) before building it.

Bracing is part of the primary structure shown on the consent. A change needs the bracing checked by the designer and BCA approval before you build it. A small bracing change can be a minor variation; bigger changes need an amendment.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE As an LBP, building work that doesn't match the consent is a ground for discipline, even if the work itself is sound.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s45A (minor variations) · LBP Handbook p.33

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116 **C.** 126 BUs

Multiply the rating per metre by the element length: 70 × 1.8 = 126 BUs. Wind and earthquake ratings are different, so do the sum for each.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Ratings per metre depend on element length. Short elements rate lower, and GIB EzyBrace elements must be at least 0.4 m long.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5 · GIB Bracing Supplement

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117 **C.** 312 BUs

1.2 × 60 = 72 BUs and 2.4 × 100 = 240 BUs. Total 72 + 240 = 312 BUs. Then check that this meets the line's minimum and that the totals for the direction meet demand.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 5

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118 **B.** No more than 12 m long, no longer than twice its width, with bracing lines on all four sides.

Ceiling diaphragms must be no more than 12 m long with a length-to-width ratio of 2:1 or less. They need bracing lines on all four sides and none inside. Protrusions are allowed but cut-outs aren't.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 5.6 and 13.5 · GIB EzyBrace Systems (ceiling diaphragms)

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119 **C.** 150 BUs

Each supporting line needs the greater of 100 BUs or 15 BUs per metre of diaphragm dimension measured at right angles to that line. For the end walls that dimension is the 10 m length, so 15 × 10 = 150 BUs. The long side walls need 15 × 6 = 90, so 100 BUs governs there.

Ref: GIB EzyBrace Systems (ceiling diaphragms, figure 21) · NZS 3604:2011 cl 13.5

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120 **B.** 25 BUs/m per lined face

The Building Product Specifications (section 3.5.3.3) give generic plasterboard walls a rating of 25 BUs/m per lined face, for walls at least 1.2 m long fully covered in 10 or 13 mm board. Proprietary systems like GIB EzyBrace have their own tested ratings.

Ref: Building Product Specifications 3.5.3.3 (via B1/AS1 2nd edition)

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121 **C.** A 6 kN connection, or a staggered double top plate

Top plate joints sit over a stud or blocking. In bracing walls, joints need a 3 kN connection up to 100 BUs and 6 kN above 100 BUs or where there's a ceiling diaphragm. A staggered double top plate does away with these joint connections.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 8.7.3

NZS 3604 FOUNDATIONS, FRAMING & TIMBER

122 **A.** Soil or rock that can permanently withstand an ultimate bearing capacity of 300 kPa (100 kPa allowable), excluding soft, expansive or unstable ground

Good ground can permanently withstand an ultimate bearing capacity of 300 kPa (an allowable bearing pressure of 100 kPa). It excludes soft or compressible soils, expansive soils, and ground that could move 25 mm or more. B1/AS1 2nd edition also excludes ground prone to liquefaction or lateral spread.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE If the ground isn't good ground, the foundations need specific engineering design.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 1.3 (definitions) · B1/AS1 2nd edition para 1.2.1

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123 **C.** At least 5 blows per 100 mm

Good ground needs at least 5 blows per 100 mm down to twice the footing width below the footing, and at least 3 blows per 100 mm below that. Lower counts mean the ground needs investigating by an engineer.

Ref: B1/AS1 2nd edition para 1.2.1 · NZS 3604:2011

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124 **D.** Timber structures (engineering design of timber)

NZS 3603 is the timber structures standard, used for engineered timber design. NZS 3604 is timber-framed buildings, NZS 3602 is timber and wood-based products for use in building, and NZS 4229 is concrete masonry buildings not requiring specific design.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 referenced documents · LBP Handbook p.30

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125 **A.** SG6, SG8 and SG10 (plus wet-use grades)

NZS 3604:2011 uses verified structural grades: SG6, SG8 and SG10, plus SG6 and SG8 (Wet) for wet-use situations. Machine-graded MSG8 and visually graded VSG8 timber both meet SG8. H1.2 and H3.2 are treatment hazard classes, not structural grades.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 2

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126 **C.** H3.2

H3.2 is for timber exposed to the weather above ground with a higher decay risk, such as decks, pergolas, exposed beams and posts not in the ground. H3.1 is for painted cladding, fascias and joinery. H4 and H5 are for in-ground use.

Ref: B2/AS1 3rd edition · Building Product Specifications 3.5 · NZS 3602

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127 **C.** H5

House piles and poles, crib walls and deck posts set in the ground need H5. H4 is for non-structural in-ground use such as fence posts and landscaping. H6 is for marine use.

Ref: Building Product Specifications 3.5 · NZS 3604:2011 Section 6

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128 **C.** H3.1

Timber cavity battens must be at least H3.1. H1.2 covers framing inside the building envelope: wall, roof (including trusses), midfloor and subfloor framing.

Ref: Building Product Specifications 3.5 (via B2/AS1 3rd edition)

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129 **B.** It's boron-treated H1.2 framing timber.

H1.2 boron-treated framing is usually dyed pink so it's easy to identify. Always check the branding too: it shows the treatment plant number, the preservative code and the hazard class.

Ref: NZS 3602 · Timber treatment requirements (MBIE guidance)

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130 **B.** Cut from the top, treat the cut surface with a suitable preservative, and never put a cut end in the ground.

Treatment doesn't always penetrate to the core, so a cut exposes less-protected timber. Cut piles from the top, treat the cut surface, and never place a cut end in the ground. Similarly, cut ends of H3.1 boards need re-priming.

Ref: NZS 3602 · NZS 3604:2011 Section 6 · BRANZ Bulletin 560

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131 **B.** 125 × 125 mm

Timber piles must be at least 125 × 125 mm if square or 140 mm diameter if round, treated to H5, set in concrete footings of at least 17.5 MPa.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 6 · BRANZ Bulletin 560

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132 **D.** Carries vertical loads only, with no bracing value

Ordinary piles carry vertical loads only. Horizontal loads at subfloor level are resisted by anchor piles, braced pile systems, cantilever piles or foundation walls.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 6

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133 **D.** 900 mm

Anchor piles need a footing at least 900 mm deep so they can resist overturning and uplift. Ordinary pile footings are at least 200 mm deep, and braced pile system footings are 450 mm.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 6 · BRANZ Bulletin 560

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134 **C.** 420,000 mm²

NZS 3604 requires at least 3500 mm² of net vent area per square metre of floor: 3500 × 120 = 420,000 mm² (0.42 m²). Vents are spaced no more than 1.8 m apart and within 750 mm of corners.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 6.14

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135 **A.** No more than 1.8 m apart and within 750 mm of each corner, so air flows through the whole subfloor

Vents must be spread around the perimeter: no more than 1.8 m apart and within 750 mm of corners, with no part of the ground more than 7.5 m from a vent. Spreading them out stops damp dead spots forming.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 6.14

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136 **D.** Lay a 0.25 mm polythene ground vapour barrier over the whole ground surface, which lets the vent area drop to 700 mm² per m² of floor.

Where the normal 3500 mm²/m² can't be achieved, covering all the subfloor ground with 0.25 mm polythene cuts the moisture coming off the ground. NZS 3604 then accepts a reduced vent area of at least 700 mm² per m².

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 6.14

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137 **A.** The clearance to the underside of floor joists for access under the floor

The 450 mm figure is an access clearance to the underside of the floor joists so the subfloor can be inspected and maintained. Piles themselves can be as low as 150 mm above finished ground. Particleboard floors need 550 mm to the underside of the sheet.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 6.4.1.1 and 6.14.4 · BRANZ Bulletin 628

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138 **C.** 0.25 mm (250 micron) polythene, with laps taped

Slabs-on-ground need a 0.25 mm polythene DPM with taped laps over at least 75 mm of compacted granular base, under a slab at least 100 mm thick. Puncture the DPM and moisture can wick into the slab and up into flooring.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 7.5 · BRANZ Appraisal 1030

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139 **C.** 600 mm

Hardfill under an NZS 3604 slab can be up to 600 mm deep, compacted in layers of no more than 150 mm. Deeper fill needs specific engineering design.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 7.5 · Standards NZ guidance on hardfill depth

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140 **B.** No. All slabs must be reinforced with ductile Grade 500E mesh (at least 2.27 kg/m²); the unreinforced and fibre-only options were removed.

B1/AS1 2nd edition requires every NZS 3604 slab to be reinforced with ductile (class E) Grade 500E mesh of at least 2.27 kg/m², carried to within 75 mm of the slab edge. The unreinforced and fibre-reinforced options were removed.

Ref: B1/AS1 2nd edition para 2.3.7

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141 **C.** 75 mm

Cover is 75 mm where concrete is cast against the ground, 50 mm against formwork or exposed to the weather, and 30 mm to a protected top surface. Too little cover lets moisture reach the steel and rust it.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 4.5.1

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142 **C.** 25 MPa

Within 500 m of the coast, including harbours, the site is in exposure zone D, which needs 25 MPa concrete. Zone C needs 20 MPa, and zone B 17.5 MPa.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 4.2 and 4.5.2

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143 **C.** Zone D

Zone D covers land within 500 m of the coast including harbours, within 100 m of tidal estuaries and inlets, all offshore islands, and other mapped areas. Zone B is low (inland) and zone C is medium. NZS 3604 has no zone E. That only appears in E2/AS1, for breaking-surf beachfronts.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 4 (Figure 4.2)

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144 **A.** Stainless steel (grade 304 or better)

In zone D, structural fixings in sheltered or exposed locations must be stainless steel (304, or 316 where appearance matters). Hot-dip galvanised is acceptable in sheltered spots in zones B and C. Fixings to H5 piles within 600 mm of the ground also need to be stainless.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 4 (durability of fixings)

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145 **D.** Hot-dip galvanised steel

Copper-based treatments corrode zinc and aluminium, so avoid galvanised steel, zinc, aluminium and aluminium-zinc coatings against copper-treated timber in sheltered or exposed locations. Use stainless steel or silicon bronze. Metal flashings need building paper between them and treated timber.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 4 · E2/AS1 Tables C.1.1.1B and C.1.1.1C

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146 **C.** 600 mm

NZS 3604 stud tables go up to 600 mm centres. Dwangs (nogs) are at 1350 mm maximum centres generally, closer behind some direct-fixed vertical claddings. Lining and cladding manufacturers may need closer spacing.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 8

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147 **B.** A measure of the weight of construction the member supports, such as half the joist spans either side of a bearer

Loaded dimension is a measure of how much of the building a member carries. For a bearer, it's half the sum of the joist spans on each side. It's an input for lintel, stud, bearer and other tables, along with things like roof weight, wind zone and span.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 1.3 (definitions)

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148 **C.** 3.0 m

For a bearer, loaded dimension is half the sum of the joist spans on each side: (3.6 + 2.4) ÷ 2 = 3.0 m. Use that with the bearer span and timber grade to read the bearer size from the table.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 cl 1.3 and Section 6

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149 **D.** Earthquake zone

Stud tables are read using roof weight, wind zone, loaded dimension, stud height and stud spacing. Earthquake zone feeds into the bracing demand, not stud sizing.

Ref: NZS 3604:2011 Section 8 (stud tables)

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150 **B.** As soon as the concrete can be cut cleanly: typically within 24 hours in warm weather (over 20°C) or 48 hours in cooler weather

Saw cuts must go in before shrinkage cracking starts. Cut about a quarter of the slab depth, typically within 24 hours above 20°C or 48 hours below. Late cuts are pointless because the slab will already have cracked where it wanted to.

Ref: BRANZ guidance on concrete slabs and control joints · NZS 3604:2011 Section 7

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151 **A.** NZS 3604:2011 is still current. A draft revision went out for public comment in 2026 but can't be used yet.

NZS 3604:2011 remains the cited standard, modified by B1/AS1 2nd edition (2025) and the Building Product Specifications. A draft revision (DZ NZS 3604) went out for consultation in mid-2026 and isn't citable until it's published and referenced.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Keep an eye on Codewords and LBP updates for when a new edition is cited.

Ref: B1/AS1 2nd edition para 2.3.1.1 · Standards NZ (DZ NZS 3604 consultation, 2026)

ACT BUILDING ACT, CODE & CONSENTS

152 **A.** To ensure people can use buildings safely and without endangering their health

The Act's purposes include making sure people can use buildings safely and without endangering their health, that buildings support health and wellbeing, that people can escape a fire, that buildings promote sustainable development, and that owners, designers, builders and BCAs are accountable. The mandatory performance criteria are in the Building Code, not the Act.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.26 (self-assessment Q1) · Building Act 2004 s3

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153 **D.** The mandatory performance criteria that all building work must meet

The Building Code (Schedule 1 of the Building Regulations 1992) is performance-based. It says how a building must perform in its intended use, not how it must be built, so you can use any method or product that meets the performance criteria. Step-by-step methods are in the Acceptable Solutions.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.27 (self-assessment Q2)

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154 **A.** The objectives, functional requirements and performance criteria

Each Building Code clause has an objective, functional requirements and performance criteria, and these are mandatory. Verification Methods and Acceptable Solutions are optional ways to comply: if you follow one, the BCA must accept that part as complying.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.27 · Building Code structure

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155 **C.** A design that differs from an Acceptable Solution or Verification Method but still shows how the work will comply with the Building Code

An alternative solution is any other way of showing compliance, for example straw bale walls, which have no Acceptable Solution. The BCA has to be satisfied on reasonable grounds that it complies, so expect to provide more detail and evidence.

Ref: LBP Handbook pp.29–30 (self-assessment Q4)

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156 **C.** The appraisal is evidence the BCA can consider, but it isn't deemed to comply, so the BCA decides whether it's satisfied.

Under section 19, a BCA must accept an Acceptable Solution or Verification Method, an MBIE determination, a current MultiProof, or a current CodeMark (product certification) used within its scope. A BRANZ Appraisal is useful supporting evidence but not deemed to comply.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s19 · building.govt.nz (CodeMark vs product appraisals)

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157 **A.** The Building Product Specifications

The Building Product Specifications (first edition 31 July 2025, Amendment 1 from 2 April 2026) collect the product standards that Acceptable Solutions such as E2/AS1, B1/AS1 and B2/AS1 now refer to. On their own they don't demonstrate Building Code compliance.

Ref: Building Product Specifications · E2/AS1 4th edition para 1.2.3

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158 **B.** The owner

Getting a building consent is the owner's responsibility. Others, such as a designer or builder, can apply on the owner's behalf with their consent. The application must show how the work will comply. Saying it complies isn't enough.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.32 (self-assessment Q6) · Building Act 2004 s14B

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159 **D.** You can't start the consented work until the building consent has been granted and issued.

Building work that needs a consent can't start until the consent is issued. Building without a required consent is an offence. The owner risks fines, being ordered to fix or remove the work, and trouble selling or insuring. As an LBP your licence is at risk too: the Board has disciplined LBPs for not making sure a consent was in place.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.32

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160 **B.** 20 working days, with the clock stopped while it waits for further information it has asked for

Section 48 gives BCAs 20 working days to decide. If the BCA requests further information, the clock is suspended until it gets it. MultiProof consents have a 10 working day limit.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s48 · LBP Handbook p.34

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161 **B.** It has lapsed, because work didn't start within 12 months of the consent being issued.

A building consent lapses if the work hasn't started within 12 months of the date it was issued, unless the BCA has agreed to a longer period. The owner, or a designer or Site LBP for them, should arrange an extension before the 12 months is up.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s52 · LBP Handbook p.34

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162 **C.** The building consent authority, by issuing a code compliance certificate

The BCA certifies compliance by issuing a code compliance certificate (CCC) once it's satisfied the work matches the consent. It usually does a final inspection first.

Ref: LBP Handbook pp.15 and 33 (self-assessment Q10)

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163 **D.** The owner

The owner must apply for the CCC once the consented work is complete (a designer or Site LBP can do it for them). The BCA then has 20 working days to decide. If no one applies within 24 months of the consent being granted, the BCA must still decide whether to issue a CCC.

Ref: Building Act 2004 ss92–93 · LBP Handbook p.14 (self-assessment Q11)

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164 **A.** At least 80% of inspections done within 3 working days of the requested date

From 22 August 2025, BCAs must carry out at least 80% of inspections within 3 working days of the date requested. Book inspections as early as you can, and don't cover up work before the inspection that's listed for it.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Missed inspections can stop the BCA issuing a CCC, which is a big problem for the owner and for you.

Ref: building.govt.nz (BCA accreditation regulatory guidance 7A)

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165 **C.** A change that doesn't significantly depart from the consent, approved by the BCA before it's built and recorded in writing

A minor variation is a small change, such as substituting a comparable product or moving a window slightly. It doesn't need a formal amendment, but the BCA must approve it before the work is done and record it in writing. Changes to primary structure, footprint or fire safety usually need a full amendment.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s45A · LBP Handbook p.33

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166 **D.** When it gives equivalent performance, is unlikely to affect compliance of other work, and the consequence of failure isn't significantly worse

Since 30 September 2024, a product substitution can be a minor variation only if all three tests are met: equivalent performance, unlikely to affect the compliance of other building work, and no significantly worse consequence if it fails. Otherwise it needs an amendment. Either way the BCA approves it before you build.

Ref: Building (Minor Variations) Amendment Regulations 2024

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167 **A.** A formal notice from the BCA or council requiring someone to fix building work that breaches the Act or regulations

A notice to fix requires the owner or the person doing or supervising the work to put things right. Not complying is an offence under section 168, with a fine of up to $200,000 plus up to $20,000 a day while it continues, or a $1,000 infringement fee.

Ref: Building Act 2004 ss164 and 168

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168 **B.** A certificate the council can issue for building work done without a required building consent, if it's satisfied the work complies

A certificate of acceptance is a way to regularise work done without a consent (or urgent work done before one could be obtained). The council inspects what it can and may limit the certificate to what it can check. It's not a substitute for getting a consent first.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s96

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169 **C.** Information from the council about a property and the proposed work, such as hazards, services and other approvals needed

A PIM tells the owner what the council knows that's relevant to the project, including natural hazards, services and whether resource consent is needed. It's optional for consented work, but mandatory before building an exempt small stand-alone dwelling (granny flat).

Ref: Building Act 2004 ss31–35

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170 **A.** When the district plan (or a regional plan) requires one for the activity

Resource consent comes from the Resource Management Act rules in district and regional plans. If the plan says the activity needs consent, you must get it before building work starts. Check early, as it's separate from the building consent.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.36 (self-assessment Q7)

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171 **B.** 15 years

B2 sets three durability periods. 50 years for structural elements and anything difficult to access or replace, or whose failure would go undetected. 15 years for moderately difficult to access or replace elements, such as the building envelope and claddings. 5 years for elements that are easy to access and replace, such as linings, renewable coatings and fixtures.

Ref: Building Code clause B2.3.1

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172 **D.** Wall framing and its fixings

Elements that provide structural stability (including floors, walls and their fixings), are difficult to access or replace, or whose failure would go undetected must last the life of the building, not less than 50 years. Coatings, linings and fixtures are 5-year elements.

Ref: Building Code clause B2.3.1(a)

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173 **B.** F4 Safety from falling

F4 Safety from falling requires barriers where people could fall 1 m or more. D1 covers access routes such as stairs, ramps and handrails. B1 is structure and E2 is external moisture.

Ref: Building Code clauses F4 and D1

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174 **C.** Yes. All building work must meet the Building Code, and clause F4 needs a barrier where someone could fall 1 m or more.

Schedule 1 exempts decks where no one could fall more than 1.5 m, even if the deck collapsed. Exempt work still has to comply with the Building Code, though, and F4 requires a barrier where the fall is 1 m or more.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s17 and Schedule 1 · Building Code clause F4

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175 **B.** E2 External moisture

E2 External moisture requires buildings to resist penetration and accumulation of moisture from outside. E1 covers surface water run-off and drainage, and E3 covers moisture generated inside, such as in bathrooms and kitchens.

Ref: Building Code clauses E1, E2 and E3

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176 **A.** It must still comply with the Building Code.

Section 17 says all building work must comply with the Building Code, whether or not it needs a consent. Exempt work just doesn't need a consent or inspections. The owner is responsible for deciding whether work is exempt, and for any consents that are needed.

Ref: Building Act 2004 ss14B and 17 · LBP Handbook p.13

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177 **C.** 70 m^2

The Schedule 1A exemption covers new, single-storey, stand-alone dwellings of up to 70 m^2 (including any internal garage), at least 2 m from boundaries and other residential buildings, built with lightweight framing and roofing. A PIM is required before work starts and the build must be finished within 2 years.

Ref: Building and Construction (Small Stand-alone Dwellings) Amendment Act 2025 · Building Act Schedule 1A

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178 **D.** Licensed building practitioners (doing or supervising the work), with plumbing, drainlaying, gas and electrical work done by authorised people

The design and building work must be carried out or supervised by LBPs, and plumbing, drainlaying, gasfitting and electrical work must be done by authorised people. The council doesn't inspect, so LBPs' records of work and the other certificates go to the council, and the owner must lodge everything within 20 working days of completion.

Ref: Building Act Schedule 1A · lbp.govt.nz (granny flat exemption)

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179 **D.** By the calculation method (or modelling); the schedule method was removed

H1/AS1 6th edition removed the schedule method. Houses now show compliance with the calculation method (or modelling under the Verification Method), comparing the design against a reference building. The 5th edition can still be used for consents lodged before 27 November 2026.

Ref: H1/AS1 6th edition (27 November 2025)

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180 **D.** R6.6

The reference building uses R6.6 for the roof. Walls in the 6th edition reference building use R1.6, because framing is now counted at a minimum 38% framing fraction. The proposed design can trade off between elements, but must still meet minimum R-values (for example roof R2.6, wall R1.0).

Ref: H1/AS1 6th edition

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181 **A.** The licensed electrical worker who did the work

Gas and electrical work generally isn't inspected by the BCA. The licensed worker certifies their own work with an energy work certificate (electrical certificate of compliance or gas certificate), and the BCA needs these before issuing the CCC.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.14

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182 **C.** It isn't law yet. The Building Amendment Bill introduced in June 2026 proposes it, and it's still before Parliament.

The Building Amendment Bill (introduced 29 June 2026) proposes proportionate liability, mandatory home warranties for larger residential jobs, and other changes. Until it passes, the current joint and several liability rules still apply.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Mention you follow changes like this through Codewords and LBP news. Assessors like to see you keep up to date.

Ref: Building Amendment Bill 2026 (lbp.govt.nz consultation notice)

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183 **B.** The approved (stamped) consent documents, including any amendments and the inspection schedule

The BCA-approved plans and specifications, any amendments and the inspection schedule must be on site so everyone builds to the consent and the inspector can check against it. Building from unapproved drawings is a common way work ends up not matching the consent.

Ref: BCA building consent conditions · LBP Handbook p.33

LBP LICENSING, ETHICS & DISCIPLINE

184 **A.** To protect consumers, lift practitioners' competence and make LBPs accountable for their work

The scheme began in November 2007 under the Building Act 2004. It sets minimum competence standards for licensing, requires skills maintenance, keeps a public register, and makes practitioners accountable to the Building Practitioners Board.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.5

185 **C.** The Registrar of Building Practitioners

The Registrar (appointed by MBIE's chief executive) makes licensing and renewal decisions, maintains the public register and sets skills maintenance requirements. The Board approves the Rules with the Minister, hears appeals against the Registrar's decisions, and deals with complaints and discipline.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.5

186 **B.** Plumbing

There are seven LBP classes: Carpentry, Design, Site, Roofing, External Plastering, Brick and Blocklaying, and Foundations. Plumbers, gasfitters and drainlayers are licensed separately through their own registration board.

Ref: LBP Handbook pp.5–6 · lbp.govt.nz (licensing classes)

187 **A.** None. Carpentry is a single licence with no areas of practice.

Carpentry has no areas of practice. Design and Site each have three (linked to building categories), Roofing has seven, and External Plastering, Brick and Blocklaying, and Foundations have two each.

Ref: lbp.govt.nz (licensing classes)

188 **A.** Carry out planning and scheduling for carpentry work

The four Carpentry competencies are: 1. Demonstrate knowledge of the regulatory environment of the building construction industry. 2. Demonstrate knowledge of current building and trade practice. 3. Carry out planning and scheduling for carpentry work. 4. Carry out carpentry work.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE Read the performance indicators under each competency. They're a good map of what the assessor will ask about.

Ref: LBP Rules 2007 Schedule 1 (Carpentry licence class competencies)

189 **D.** An assessor reviews your evidence, interviews you about the competencies (recorded, usually by video call) and phones your referees

After a completeness check, an assessor reviews your project records and other evidence, holds a recorded interview (usually on Microsoft Teams) about the competencies, and contacts your referees. The Registrar then decides, and you can appeal to the Board. There's no written exam.

Ref: lbp.govt.nz (standard application)

190 **B.** A technically credible person, preferably an LBP, who has seen you do RBW in the last 5 years and isn't family

You need at least two referees for each area of practice. They can't be family, must be technically credible (preferably LBPs) and must have seen you carry out RBW within the last 5 years.

Ref: lbp.govt.nz (experience pathway checklist)

191 **C.** You can use the streamlined (qualified) pathway, but you still need referees and an assessment interview.

The NZ Certificate in Carpentry (Level 4) is a recognised qualification (the list was updated in September 2024). It lets you use the streamlined pathway with a certified copy of the qualification, but you still need referees and an interview.

Ref: LBP Rules (Schedule 2 recognised qualifications, amended 2024) · lbp.govt.nz (streamlined application)

192 **A.** Every year, by replying to the Registrar and paying the fee within 20 working days

Licences are renewed annually. The Registrar writes about 20 working days before your licence expires, and you must confirm your details and pay within 20 working days. If you don't, your licence is suspended, and cancelled if it isn't sorted within 12 months.

Ref: lbp.govt.nz (relicensing) · LBP Amendment Rules 2024

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193 **B.** 12 hours (points) of elective activities, 2 on-the-job learning examples, and the specified Codewords articles and quizzes

Skills maintenance runs on a two-year cycle and must be done before renewal. For Carpentry it's 12 hours of electives (1 hour = 1 point), two on-the-job learning examples, and all specified Codewords articles and quizzes. If it isn't met, the licence can be suspended, then cancelled.

Ref: lbp.govt.nz (skills maintenance) · LBP Handbook p.11

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194 **C.** 10 working days

Under section 302 you must tell the Registrar in writing about any change in circumstances (any change to the information you gave them) within 10 working days. Failing to do so is an offence with a fine of up to $5,000.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s302

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195 **C.** 25 October 2022

The Building (Code of Ethics for Licensed Building Practitioners) Order 2021 became enforceable on 25 October 2022. Breaching it is a ground for discipline. It has four principles and 19 standards.

Ref: Building (Code of Ethics for LBPs) Order 2021 · lbp.govt.nz (Code of Ethics)

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196 **D.** Take responsibility for your actions

The four principles are: work safely, act within the law, take responsibility for your actions, and behave professionally. Each has its own standards, 19 in total.

Ref: lbp.govt.nz (Code of Ethics)

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197 **D.** Tell the client about the delay as soon as it becomes apparent.

The Code of Ethics requires LBPs to advise clients of any delays as soon as they become apparent. It also expects you to explain risks to clients, keep them informed, and act in their interests.

Ref: Code of Ethics for LBPs (take responsibility for your actions)

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198 **A.** Refuse to change it without BCA approval, and explain the risks and the legal requirements to the client.

The Code says you must normally follow your client's instructions, but not where doing so would break the law. You must comply with the law, explain risks to your client, and build to the consent. Changes need BCA approval first.

Ref: Code of Ethics for LBPs · Building Act 2004 s40

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199 **B.** You must price work fairly and reasonably.

Under behaving professionally, the Code includes pricing work fairly and reasonably, acting in good faith during dispute resolution, declaring and managing conflicts of interest, keeping client information confidential, respecting cultural norms and values, and running your business in a methodical and responsible way.

Ref: Code of Ethics for LBPs (behave professionally)

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200 **C.** Take responsibility for health and safety and report the unsafe behaviour.

Under the work safely principle, LBPs must take responsibility for health and safety and report unsafe behaviour by others on a building site. Under HSWA, PCBUs sharing a site also have to consult, cooperate and coordinate.

Ref: Code of Ethics for LBPs (work safely) · HSWA 2015 s34

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201 **D.** All of the above

Grounds for discipline include negligence or incompetence (including poor supervision), building work that doesn't follow the consent, failing to provide a record of work or certificate of work, false information to get licensed, holding yourself out as licensed for work you're not, breaching the Code of Ethics, working outside your competence, certain convictions, and bringing the regime into disrepute.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.7 (self-assessment Q12) · Building Act 2004 s317

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202 **D.** All of the above

Under section 318 the Board can cancel a licence, suspend it for up to 12 months, restrict the work you can do, censure you, order training, and fine you. It can also order you to pay costs and publish its decision.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.8 (self-assessment Q13) · Building Act 2004 s318

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203 **B.** $10,000

Section 318(1)(f) caps the Board's disciplinary fine at $10,000. The LBP Handbook says $50,000, but that figure is the criminal maximum for RBW offences under sections 85 and 86, which go through the courts. Changes proposed in 2025 would raise the Board's maximum to $20,000 and suspensions to 24 months, so check whether they've passed.

ASSESSOR'S NOTE If your handbook and the Act disagree, the Act wins. Assessors appreciate it when you know the difference.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s318(1)(f) · regulation.govt.nz (RIS on LBP fines, 2025)

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204 **D.** Anyone

Section 315 says any person can complain, and the Board can also start its own inquiries. Complaints use the approved form and can't be anonymous. The Board doesn't resolve payment disputes. Complaints about people who aren't LBPs go to MBIE or the council.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s315 · lbp.govt.nz (making a complaint)

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205 **B.** I only do work I know how to do well, and I get support when I take on something unfamiliar.

Section 314B says an LBP must not misrepresent their competence and must only carry out or supervise building work within it. Your licence covers a range of work, but you should only do the parts you're competent in, with mentoring or expert help for new areas.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.11 (self-assessment Q14) · Building Act 2004 s314B

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206 **A.** Your licence status and history, and any disciplinary action in the last 3 years

The public register shows whether you're licensed and in which class, your licence history, and disciplinary outcomes from the last 3 years. Homeowners are encouraged to check it before engaging someone for RBW.

Ref: lbp.govt.nz (public register)

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207 **C.** To the District Court, within 20 working days

Board decisions can be appealed to the District Court within 20 working days. Decisions of the Registrar (such as declining a licence) are appealed to the Board.

Ref: Building Act 2004 ss330–331 · LBP Handbook p.5

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208 **A.** A single residential unit with a risk matrix score under 12 on every external elevation

Category 1 is a single residential unit scoring under 12 on every elevation. Category 2 is a single unit scoring 12 or more on any elevation, or a multi-unit residential building under 10 m. Category 3 is multi-unit residential over 10 m, or buildings with non-residential parts. Most simple houses are Category 1 or 2.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.6

CON CONTRACTS & CONSUMER PROTECTION

209 **C.** $30,000 including GST

Residential building work costing $30,000 or more (including GST) must have a written contract with the minimum content set out in the regulations. That's the total price for the job, so splitting it into several invoices just under $30,000 doesn't get around it.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s362F · LBP Handbook p.17

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210 **A.** When the job will cost $30,000 or more (including GST), or whenever the client asks for them

The disclosure statement (your skills, qualifications, licensing, insurance and guarantees) and the standard checklist must be given before the contract is signed if the work is $30,000 or more, or if the client asks for them. Knowingly giving false or misleading information, or leaving information out, can lead to fines of up to $50,000 for individuals and $150,000 for organisations.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s362D · LBP Handbook p.17

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211 **D.** To all residential building work, whatever the price and whether or not there's a written contract. You can't contract out of them.

The implied warranties in section 362I apply to every residential building contract regardless of value, and section 362K stops parties contracting out of them. Later owners of the home can also rely on them.

Ref: Building Act 2004 ss362I–362K · LBP Handbook p.17

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212 **B.** The work will be finished for the price first quoted, whatever variations the client asks for

The implied warranties cover proper and competent work to the plans and specs, suitable (and new) materials, compliance with the law, reasonable care and skill, completion within the agreed or a reasonable time, a home fit to live in, and fitness for any stated purpose. Price changes from client-requested variations aren't covered by them.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s362I

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213 **D.** Up to 10 years

Homeowners can bring a claim under the implied warranties for up to 10 years (the long-stop limit in section 393). That's separate from the first-year defect repair period.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s393(2) · LBP Handbook p.19

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214 **C.** 12 months

For 12 months from completion, the contractor must fix any defects the client notifies in writing, within a reasonable time. If you dispute a defect during this period, it's up to you to prove it isn't your fault (or your subcontractor's, or due to products you used).

Ref: Building Act 2004 s362Q · LBP Handbook p.19

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215 **A.** The homeowner has to prove there's a defect, but the implied warranties still apply for up to 10 years.

Within the 12-month defect repair period the contractor must prove a disputed defect isn't their fault. After that, the homeowner has to prove it. You can still be liable under the implied warranties for up to 10 years.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.19

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216 **A.** Copies of relevant insurance policies, guarantees and warranties (with how to claim and whether they transfer), and maintenance information for the work

Section 362T requires, for all residential work, copies of insurance policies covering the work, guarantees and warranties for materials or services (how to claim, whether transferable, whether they must be registered), and information on maintaining the work where it affects compliance or a guarantee. Not providing it can lead to a $500 infringement fee.

Ref: Building Act 2004 s362T · LBP Handbook pp.18–19

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217 **B.** $500

Each of these is an infringement offence with a $500 fee. More serious offences, such as knowingly giving false or misleading information in the disclosure statement, can be prosecuted with fines of up to $50,000 for individuals and $150,000 for organisations.

Ref: Building Act 2004 ss362D, 362F and 362T · LBP Handbook p.17

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218 **C.** Default clauses in the Building Act regulations apply automatically, alongside the implied warranties.

Where a residential contract of $30,000 or more isn't in writing, or misses the minimum content, default clauses are implied. For example, the contractor must get the necessary consents before starting and provide CCCs before the final payment claim. The contractor can also be fined for not having a written contract.

Ref: Building (Residential Consumer Rights and Remedies) Regulations 2014 · LBP Handbook p.18

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219 **D.** The default provisions apply, with monthly progress payments.

The Construction Contracts Act gives default payment provisions (monthly progress payments) where the contract doesn't cover payments, bans pay-when-paid clauses, and offers fast adjudication of disputes. It covers residential and commercial construction contracts.

Ref: Construction Contracts Act 2002 · LBP Handbook p.20

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220 **B.** The prescribed notice (Form 1) explaining how to respond and what happens if the claim isn't answered or paid

Every payment claim must include the prescribed notice (Form 1). It tells the payer how to respond, for example with a payment schedule, and the consequences of not responding or not paying.

Ref: Construction Contracts Act 2002 · LBP Handbook p.20

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221 **C.** You, as the main contractor, because you're responsible to the homeowner for your subcontractors' work

The main contractor must fix defects notified within the 12-month repair period, including work done by subcontractors. That's why it pays to check subcontractors' work as the job goes, not just at the end.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.19

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222 **A.** The total cost of all the building work, including subcontractors, supplies, fixtures and GST

The price is the total cost of all the building work, including supplies, fixtures and fittings, subcontractors and GST. You can only leave out a subcontractor's work if they contract with the client separately.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.18

H&S HEALTH & SAFETY ON SITE

223 **D.** It provides a framework for the health and safety of workers and workplaces.

HSWA sets a framework for keeping workers and others safe at work. Construction is one of the highest-risk sectors in New Zealand, with worker fatalities more than double the average for other sectors.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.22 (self-assessment Q9)

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224 **A.** Person conducting a business or undertaking

A PCBU is a person conducting a business or undertaking, such as a building company or a self-employed builder. PCBUs have the primary duty to ensure, so far as is reasonably practicable, the health and safety of workers and others affected by the work.

Ref: Health and Safety at Work Act 2015 s17 and s36 · LBP Handbook p.22

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225 **C.** You can stop or refuse the work if you believe it exposes you or others to a serious risk, and you should tell your manager as soon as possible.

Workers have the right to stop or refuse work that would expose them or anyone else to a serious health or safety risk. You must let your manager know as soon as you can. Your job can't be threatened for raising or acting on a health and safety concern.

Ref: LBP Handbook pp.22–23 · HSWA 2015

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226 **C.** The business. It can't charge workers for PPE they need.

In most cases the business must provide PPE at no cost to the worker and train them to use and maintain it. Workers can supply their own if they choose, but it must be checked and approved by the business.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.22

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227 **D.** To take reasonable care for their own health and safety and that of others, and follow reasonable instructions

Workers must take reasonable care of their own health and safety, take reasonable care that what they do (or don't do) doesn't harm others, follow reasonable instructions, and cooperate with reasonable health and safety policies and procedures.

Ref: HSWA 2015 s45 · LBP Handbook p.23

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228 **B.** A death, a notifiable injury or illness, or a notifiable incident

Notifiable events are deaths, notifiable injuries or illnesses (for example, injuries needing immediate hospital admission) and notifiable incidents (dangerous events like a collapse). The PCBU must notify WorkSafe as soon as possible, phone 0800 030 040 for a death, and keep records for at least 5 years.

Ref: HSWA 2015 ss23–25, 56–57 · LBP Handbook p.24

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229 **A.** Don't disturb it until a WorkSafe inspector authorises you to, except to help the injured, make the site safe or protect property.

After a notifiable event the site must be preserved until an inspector says otherwise. The exceptions are helping injured people, removing a body, making the area safe or minimising risk, or protecting property. Then notify WorkSafe as soon as possible.

Ref: HSWA 2015 s55 · LBP Handbook p.24

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230 **C.** They must consult, cooperate and coordinate with each other. Duties can't be contracted out.

Where PCBUs share duties, such as several trades on one site, each must, so far as is reasonably practicable, consult, cooperate and coordinate activities with the others. You can't transfer a health and safety duty to someone else by contract.

Ref: HSWA 2015 ss29 and 34

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231 **D.** Eliminate it if you can. If not, minimise it with substitution, isolation or engineering controls, then administrative controls, and PPE last.

The hierarchy of controls starts with elimination (for example, prefabricating at ground level). If that's not reasonably practicable, minimise the risk with substitution, isolation and engineering controls (such as edge protection or scaffolding), then administrative controls, and finally PPE.

Ref: Health and Safety at Work (General Risk and Workplace Management) Regulations 2016 reg 6

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232 **B.** At least 24 hours

Trenches and pits more than 1.5 m deep (and deeper than they are wide at the top) are notifiable hazardous work, which needs at least 24 hours' notice to WorkSafe. So do erecting or dismantling scaffolding with a fall risk of 5 m or more, and some other high-risk work.

Ref: Health and Safety in Employment Regulations 1995 reg 26 · worksafe.govt.nz (hazardous work notifications)

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233 **A.** No. Work on residential buildings up to and including two full storeys is excluded from the 5 m notification rule, but you must still manage the fall risk.

The 24-hour notification for work where someone could fall 5 m or more excludes residential buildings of up to and including two full storeys, work done only from a ladder, and minor or routine maintenance. Being exempt from notification doesn't remove the duty to control the fall risk with edge protection, scaffolding or other controls.

Ref: Health and Safety in Employment Regulations 1995 reg 26 · worksafe.govt.nz

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234 **B.** Fall risks must be managed at any height, and you should never stand on a top plate without fall protection.

WorkSafe's 2026 guidance says there's no minimum height: fall risks must be managed at any height. Never stand on a top plate without fall protection. Ladders are for short, low-risk work only, set at 4:1 and extending 1 m above the landing.

Ref: worksafe.govt.nz (Working at height in New Zealand, 2026)

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235 **B.** Whether it contains asbestos. Pre-2000 buildings are likely to, and it must be identified and removed safely, by a licensed removalist where required.

Buildings from before 2000 are likely to contain asbestos. It must be identified before work starts. Friable asbestos needs a Class A licensed removalist, and more than 10 m^2 of non-friable asbestos needs at least a Class B licence. Licensed removalists must notify WorkSafe at least 5 days before starting.

Ref: worksafe.govt.nz (asbestos removal)

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236 **D.** Toilets and hand-washing, clean drinking water, first aid facilities, and a sheltered place for meal breaks

Workers must have toilets and hand-washing facilities, clean drinking water, first aid facilities, and somewhere to have a meal break in reasonable comfort and shelter. They also need to know what to do in an emergency.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.23 · GRWM Regulations 2016

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237 **A.** Make sure visitors aren't harmed by hazards in the workplace you control, for example by escorting them and briefing them on hazards.

As the PCBU controlling the workplace, you must ensure, so far as is reasonably practicable, that other people, including clients visiting the site, aren't put at risk by the work. Waivers don't transfer HSWA duties.

Ref: LBP Handbook p.19 · HSWA 2015 s36
